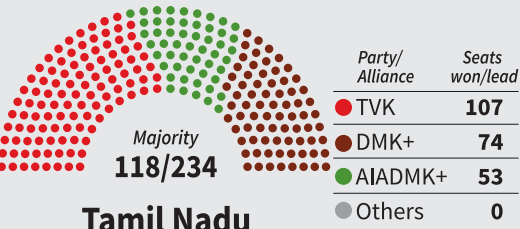
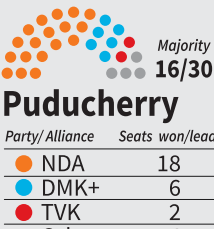
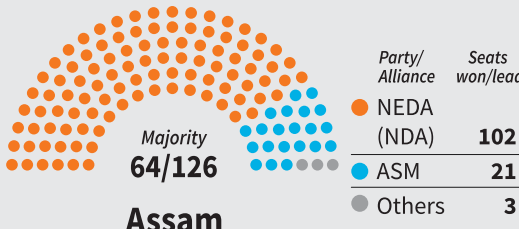
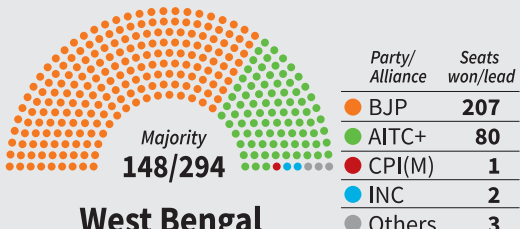
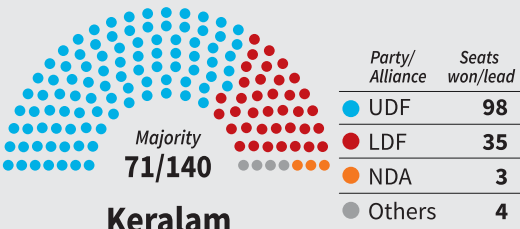


the hindu businessline



Source: ECI, as of 10 pm



BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

Shock verdict in Tamil Nadu; BJP storms Bengal, holds Assam; UDF returns in Kerala

BIG CHURN. Surprise challenger TVK breaks the Kazhagam duopoly in TN as CM Stalin loses; Mamata Banerjee defeated in Bhabanipur

Poornima Joshi
New Delhi



ALL JUBILANT. TVK president Joseph Vijay waving to supporters as the party led in the Tamil Nadu Assembly vote count on Monday. In Kolkata, BJP supporters seen celebrating the party's sweep in the West Bengal elections **ANI**



from Jorhat. The BJP had a vote share of 37.86 per cent, while the Congress's vote share was 29.8 per cent till the time of going to press.

CONG LEADS KERALA

In Kerala, the Congress (63 seats)-led United Democratic Front, which includes the Indian Union Muslim League (with 22 seats), the Kerala Congress (with 7 seats), the Revolutionary Socialist Party (3 seats), the Kerala Congress Jacob (1 seat) and the Communist Marxist Party Kerala State Committee (CMPKSC, 1 seat) accounted for a majority of 97 seats in the 140-member Assembly.

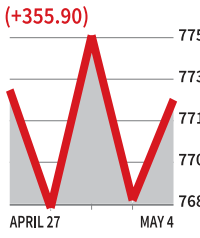
The CPI(M)-led Left Democratic Front with 26 seats and its partner CPI with 8 seats were ousted. The BJP managed to win 3 seats and a vote share of about 11.42 per cent.

NDA TAKES PONDY

In Puducherry, the NDA was headed for a majority, with the AINRC winning 12 seats and the BJP four in the 30-member Assembly. The DMK led in five seats, while the TVK secured two.

Detailed reports p6,7,8

SENSEX



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24119.30	+121.75
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.97	+0.03
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.08	+0.17
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	147507.00	-2154
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	240120.00	-211

‘Commodity derivative trade by banks, insurers not for now’

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India and the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India are not in favour of allowing banks and insurance companies to participate in the commodity derivatives market, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Monday. Speaking on the sidelines of the IMC Capital Markets Conference at the National Stock Exchange of India, Pandey said both regulators have a “valid rationale” for their cautious stance.

In September last year, SEBI had said that it would engage with the government to enable banks and pension funds trade in commodities, aiming to deepen the market.

“They were engaged with them, and they had their rationale that, at this moment, they do not feel it is the right time,” he said, adding that

insurance, being a long-term product, may not align well with commodity derivatives.

GST CONCERNS

SEBI has also requested the government to address structural GST (Goods and Services Tax) issues faced by investors trading in physically settled commodity derivatives, Pandey said.

“We have proposed an integrated GST mechanism in the place of State GST. Since warehouses are spread across multiple locations, participants are required to register in several States for delivery purposes. This is quite cumbersome,” he said.

He also flagged emerging risks from advanced artificial intelligence models such as Mythos AI, noting that such tools could test market resilience.

“SEBI will soon issue an initial advisory on risks arising from such models and AI-led vulnerability detection tools,” Pandey said.

RECORD YEAR. NEW ERA. FIVE COMPANIES. ONE VEDANTA LEGACY.

Vedanta demerger effective from 1st May 2026

VEDANTA LTD Q4FY26 HIGHLIGHTS

REVENUE
₹ 51,524 Cr
↑ 29% YoY

EBITDA
₹ 18,447 Cr
↑ 59% YoY

PROFIT AFTER TAX
₹ 9,352 Cr
↑ 89% YoY

Record Margin of c.44%, up 915 bps YoY

BEST-EVER QUARTERLY PERFORMANCE

VEDANTA LTD FY26 HIGHLIGHTS

REVENUE
₹ 1,74,075 Cr
↑ 15% YoY

EBITDA
₹ 55,976 Cr
↑ 29% YoY

PROFIT AFTER TAX
₹ 25,096 Cr
↑ 22% YoY

Margin of c.39%, up 470 bps YoY

HISTORIC-BEST ANNUAL RESULTS

COST OF PRODUCTION
Aluminium ↓ 5% YoY
Zinc India ↓ 9% YoY
Both lowest in 5 years

CREDIT RATING
Vedanta Ltd: AA
Reaffirmed by CRISIL & ICRA

Vedanta Resources: BB-
Upgraded by Fitch Ratings

NET DEBT/EBITDA
0.95x
vs 1.22x in Q4FY25
Best in 14 Quarters;

Net Debt Reduced by
₹ 7,370 Cr in Q4FY26

RETURN ON CAPITAL EMPLOYED
c.32%
↑ 539 bps YoY
Best-Ever ROCE

TOTAL SHAREHOLDER RETURN
48.6%
2.1 times of Nifty Metal Index
Among top 3 wealth creators in the
Nifty 100 companies

GROWTH CAPEX
₹ 14,918 Cr
Invested in FY26
↑ 18% YoY



DESH KI ZAROORATON KE LIYE

First metal tapped from India's largest 525 kA Smelter at BALCO

Acquired Incab Industries for downstream copper and aluminium

Offshore gas discovery at Cairn Ambe Block

Secured 5 year, 500MW PPA for Meenakshi and Athena Power Plants

VEDANTA, ONE OF THE WORLD'S LEADING PRODUCERS OF:

METALS | OIL & GAS | CRITICAL MINERALS | POWER | TECHNOLOGY

QUICKLY.

Tata Technologies Q4 profit rises 8% ₹204 cr



New Delhi: Global product engineering and digital services firm Tata Technologies reported an 8 per cent increase in consolidated net profit to ₹204.17 crore during the March quarter as against ₹188.87 crore in the corresponding year-ago quarter, Tata Technologies said in a regulatory filing. Consolidated revenue from operations was at ₹1,572.22 crore (₹1,285.65 crore). Total expenses were higher at ₹1,382.62 crore (₹1,088.2 crore). For FY26, consolidated net profit was at ₹546.59 crore as compared to ₹676.95 crore in FY25. Consolidated revenue from operations in FY26 stood at ₹5,505.57 crore (₹5,168.45 crore).

Exports lift Bajaj Auto sales up 40% in Apr

RECOVERY ALL ACROSS. Commercial vehicle exports, primarily 3W, jumped 125%, while 2W exports rose 78%

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Bajaj Auto on Monday reported a 40 per cent year-on-year rise in total sales for April at 5.13 lakh units, driven by strong export demand. Exports surged 83 per cent to 2.65 lakh units, overtaking domestic volumes, which grew 13 per cent to 2.48 lakh units, according to the company's disclosure.

Commercial vehicle exports, primarily three-wheelers, jumped 125 per cent, while two-wheeler exports rose 78 per cent, highlighting a broad-based recovery in overseas markets.

Nearly 80 per cent of the incremental volume growth in April came from exports, underlining the extent to which Bajaj Auto's performance is once again being driven by its global business.

Analysts say the recovery in three-wheelers signals not

Sales at a glance				
Segment	April 2025	April 2026	Change (Units)	Change (%)
2W Domestic	1,88,615	2,10,063	21,448	11
2W Exports	1,29,322	2,29,890	1,00,568	78
2W Total	3,17,937	4,39,953	1,22,016	38
CV Domestic	32,000	38,147	6,147	19
CV Exports	15,873	35,692	19,819	125
CV Total	47,873	73,839	25,966	54
Domestic Total	2,20,615	2,48,210	27,595	13
Exports Total	1,45,195	2,65,582	1,20,387	83
Overall Total	3,65,810	5,13,792	1,47,982	40

just a cyclical upturn, but a restoration of Bajaj's core earnings engine, supported by favourable currency movements and a richer product mix.

EXPORTS SOAR AGAIN

Analysts at Elara Capital and Motilal Oswal attribute the surge to improving macro conditions in key export markets, including currency

stabilisation in Africa, particularly Nigeria, and a recovery in Sri Lanka. With exports now accounting for over half of total volumes, Bajaj is also strengthening its position as a net foreign exchange earner, providing a hedge against domestic cost pressures.

Domestic growth reflects continued stress in entry-level segments even as the

Bajaj Auto board will meet on May 6 to consider its Q4 results and a potential share buyback

company pivots toward higher-value offerings such as CNG, EVs and premium motorcycles. However, the renewed reliance on exports introduces risks. Any disruption in key markets or shipping routes, particularly in the Red Sea corridor, could impact momentum.

TRIPLE-ENGINE PHASE

Brokerages including CLSA and JM Financial see FY27 as a "triple-engine" phase for Bajaj Auto, driven by exports, clean mobility and premiumisation.

The company is expected to expand its CNG portfolio following the Freedom 125,

while scaling up its electric scooter Chetak, where it holds a strong No. 2 position with around 23 per cent market share, according to industry estimates.

Premiumisation is expected to be the third growth lever, with a new motorcycle brand planned in the ₹1.5-2 lakh segment and an expanded Triumph line-up in sub-350cc categories, benefiting from a lower GST structure.

BUYBACK TRIGGER

The strong export-led performance comes ahead of a key capital allocation decision. Bajaj Auto's board will meet on May 6 to consider its March quarter results and a potential share buyback.

With surplus cash estimated at ₹15,000-16,000 crore, analysts see the company entering a phase where export cash flows fund both its EV/CNG transition and shareholder returns.

Beverage makers strengthen affordability play this Summer

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Leading beverage makers are strengthening their affordability play in the aerated beverage segment while ramping up distribution, as they hope to garner stronger growth rates this Summer. The stronger focus on popular price-points also comes at a time when entry of new players has intensified competition. As per estimates by Crisil Ratings, soft-drink bottlers are poised to garner 15 per cent revenue growth this fiscal, driven by hotter summers and rising penetration after subdued growth last fiscal.

In its global Q1 earnings call, beverage major Coca-Cola said that it is focusing on driving "affordability" and growing rural reach in the India market. Sundee Bajoria, Vice-President, Coca-Cola India and South-West Asia, told *businessline*, "In India, we are focused on shaping a beverage portfolio that offers meaningful choices across varying needs and occasions. Our ambition is to be within arm's reach of desire for our consumers, ensuring our beverages are both easily available and affordable. Through single-serve and multi-serve entry packs, we expand access and everyday relevance, while premiumising select elements of our portfolio to elevate consumer experiences on special moments and occasions."

PepsiCo has also expanded its affordable offerings. Nitin Bhandari, Vice-President and GM - Beverages, PepsiCo India and South Asia, "Value and affordability remain key factors when it comes to on-the-go, out-of-home hydration choices. This season, consumers can enjoy our latest innovation under Nimbooz — locally-inspired flavours like Rosey Twist, Orangey Twist and



As per estimates by Crisil Ratings, soft-drink bottlers are poised to garner 15% revenue growth this fiscal

Lemony Masala Twist — priced at ₹10. At the same time, our iconic brands like Pepsi and 7UP are also available at ₹10 packs across various regions."

PepsiCo's leading bottler Varun Beverages said that as part of its strategy to ramp up distribution, it plans to add nearly half-a-million additional outlets this year.

HOT COMPETITION

Crisil Ratings in its recent report noted that the competitive landscape is heating up in the soft drinks sector with new entrants launching products at popular price-points. "As a result, their market share has increased to an estimated 6-7 per cent last fiscal, from about 2 per cent in FY24," it added.

Saurabh Munjal, Co-Founder and CEO, Archian Foods, known for Lahori Zeera said, "Popular price points such as ₹10 remain highly relevant because it enables mass trials, impulse consumption and everyday habit formation. Brands that combine taste, trust and consistency at accessible price points will continue to win. As far as summer growth is concerned, demand is fundamentally strong."

IHCL, Lemon Tree Hotels topped room additions in 2025

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Indian Hotels Company Ltd (IHCL) and Lemon Tree Hotels added the largest number of keys in the Indian market in CY25, a report by consultancy HVS Anarock shows. Overall 14,199 branded hotel rooms were added last year, a growth of 5 per cent over 2024.

IHCL and Lemon Tree Hotels topped in both — the number of property openings and room addition. IHCL opened 30 properties in 2025 and added around 3,000 keys. This excludes hotels on-boarded through acquisitions.

Lemon Tree Hotels grew its inventory by 1,601 keys

with the opening of 21 hotels.

However, new property addition in the country fell to 176 compared to 200 in 2024.

SUPPLY EXPANSION

Domestic brands led supply expansion accounting for 70 per cent of the new property openings and 57 per cent of keys.

International operators, however, focused on larger-format developments with an average hotel size of 117 keys compared to 65 keys for domestic brands, HVS Anarock said.

Accor, Marriott and Radisson were among top five companies adding rooms in 2025. In terms of property openings, the top five list included The Fern Hotels &



ROOM TO GROW. Lemon Tree Hotels grew its inventory by 1,601 keys with the opening of 21 hotels

Resorts, Radisson and Sarovar.

Mumbai, Udaipur, Bengaluru, Gurugram and Goa saw the highest number of hotel room additions last year.

This year, Dehradun made it to the top five at the expense of Gurugram.

BEYOND METROS

"We are moving beyond the traditional metro markets because the Indian traveller is now everywhere and our network is expanding to meet them where they are, while maintaining the discipline and consistency that define our brand," said

Neelendra Singh, Managing Director, Lemon Tree Hotels.

Domestic tourism remains the key driver for the Indian hospitality industry and the demand base is getting diversified, too, with support from pilgrimage tours, weddings, concerts and marquee events.

According to HVS Anarock, hotel development activity remained robust in 2025 with brand signings reaching a new high of approximately 64,118 keys across 586 properties. It said not just tier-II and -III, but even tier-IV markets are becoming central to the next phase of growth, supported by improved connectivity, rising local demand and lower development costs.

Ambuja Cement Q4 profit up 79% on volume growth

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Ambuja Cement, part of the Adani Group reported a 78.5 per cent year-on-year jump in consolidated net profit to ₹1,830 crore for the fourth quarter of FY26, supported by strong volume growth and better realisations, though the base remains partly non-comparable due to recent acquisitions. Revenue from operations rose 10 per cent to ₹10,892 crore, driven by 8.6 per cent growth in cement sales and a sharp 37 per cent increase in the ready-mix concrete segment.

The company reported its highest-ever quarterly sales volume of 19.9 million tonnes, up 10 per cent. Operating EBITDA stood at ₹1,464 crore, with margins at 13.4 per cent, translating to EBITDA of ₹735 per tonne.

For FY26, net profit rose 10 per cent to ₹4,728 crore,

Q4 scorecard (in ₹ cr)

	Q4 FY25	Q4 FY26	Change
Revenue from operations	9,894	10,892	10.0
Profit	1,025	1,830	78.5

FACTSHEET

- Revenue from operations rose 10% to ₹10,892 crore
- Highest-ever quarterly sales volume of 19.9 mt
- Operating EBITDA at ₹1,464 crore, margins at 13.4%

while revenue grew 19 per cent to ₹40,446 crore. Annual EBITDA stood at ₹6,539 crore, with the company achieving its highest-ever annual volume of 73.7 mt and EBITDA of ₹887 per tonne. However, the company cautioned that year-on-year comparisons are not strictly like-to-like due to acquisitions.

"FY25 does not have Orient Cements, while Penna was acquired and consolidated from August 16, 2025, which is only 7.5 months of

FY25 as against 12 months of FY26. While Orient is only for 11 months of FY26 and was not there in FY25," said Vinod Bahety, Whole-time Director and CEO, Ambuja Cement.

He added that despite sectoral headwinds, the company delivered a resilient performance, aided by higher share of premium products, improved realisations and better utilisation of assets, alongside progress on its "one cement platform" strategy, following the integ-

ration of Sanghi and Penna Cement.

CONSOLIDATION PHASE

The company said FY26 marked a transition from expansion to consolidation. Ambuja also remained debt-free, supported by strong liquidity and high credit ratings.

However, it flagged persistent cost pressures from fuel, diesel, packaging material shortages and rupee depreciation, which are expected to continue into H1FY27. The company is addressing these through fuel mix optimisation, higher renewable energy adoption, logistics efficiency improvements and disciplined production planning.

On the outlook, Ambuja expects cement demand growth of around 5 per cent in FY27, citing geopolitical uncertainties and expectations of a below-normal monsoon.

Jindal Stainless net profit up 41% in Q4 on lower base

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Jindal Stainless reported a strong performance for the March quarter, with net profit rising 41 per cent year-on-year to ₹834 crore, compared with ₹509 crore in the same period last year, aided partly by a favourable base. However, it flagged a cautious outlook, noting that uncertainty is likely to persist in the coming months amid the ongoing conflict in West Asia.

Revenue for the quarter grew 11 per cent to ₹11,337 crore (₹10,198 crore), reflecting steady demand conditions despite global volatility. The board has recommended a final dividend of ₹3 per share for FY26. The company has achieved 37 per cent increase in EBITDA at ₹1,455 crore (₹1,061 crore).

For the full year, it recor-



Abhyuday Jindal, Managing Director, Jindal Stainless

ded sales growth of 8 per cent, falling short of its 9.5 per cent target, primarily linked to the West Asia war.

CHALLENGING TIMES

Abhyuday Jindal, Managing Director, Jindal Stainless, said despite challenging times, the company has managed to post an encouraging profit, as it focused on value-added products and improved cost efficiencies. The domestic stainless steel industry continues to operate in a challenging environ-

ment caused by the West Asia crisis and India's liberal trade policies, he said.

Concerns over cheap and substandard imports remain even as the industry continues to advocate implementation of quality control order to curb unfair imports and safeguard the long-term interests of the domestic stainless steel industry, he said.

Jindal Stainless has set a capex of ₹2,600 crore in FY27 with the focus to complete the ongoing projects. It has expressed serious concern over cheap imports even as its domestic capacity utilisation hovers around 60 per cent.

Tarun Khulbe, CEO, Jindal Stainless, said the cost of propane had gone up almost three times to ₹1.90 lakh a tonne; a similar trend was seen in LPG due to short-supply.

COST RISE IMPACT

The real impact of the cost

rise will be felt in the coming days also, as the company used the inventory in March quarter, he added. When prices rise sharply, he said many of the buyers are delaying fresh order on hopes that prices will come down soon with daily signals of war coming to an end soon.

The company expects EBITDA per tonne to fall to ₹18,000-20,000 tonne in the first half of this fiscal against ₹21,700 a tonne achieved in FY26. It has given sales guidance of 2.8 mt in FY27 against 2.5 mt achieved in FY26. Given the fluid market condition, it will review the guidance after the first half of this fiscal.

On Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism roll-out in Europe, Jindal said the delay in appointment of validators for green energy utilisation is the missing link, but the company is making its mark in new markets in Japan and South Korea.

NCLAT approves Adani bid for JP Associates, rejects Vedanta plea

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) has upheld the Adani Group's ₹14,535-crore resolution plan for Jaiprakash Associates and rejected the challenge of Anil Agarwal-led Vedanta.

The NCLAT bench, comprising Chairperson Ashok Bhushan and Member Technical Barun Mitra, held that no grounds had been made out to interfere with the order of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT), which had approved the resolution process.

The Tribunal also upheld the decision of the Committee of Creditors (CoC) and said the decision was taken in the exercise of "commercial wisdom" after an overall evaluation of resolution plans.

Vedanta sent an addendum on November 8,



2025, after it had already submitted its final resolution plan on October 14, 2025.

The NCLAT said that this addendum was not just a clarification — it changed/modified the plan.

Since it was a modification, the CoC was justified in not considering it at the 24th CoC meeting on November 14, 2025, said the Tribunal, adding that the decision was neither invalid nor untenable.

NO VALID REASON

It further held that there was no material irregularity by the Resolution Professional in how the process was conducted. "So, the court found no valid reason to interfere

with the earlier order approving the process outcome, and therefore dismissed Vedanta's appeal," it said.

The CoC's decision to approve Adani Enterprises' plan could not be termed arbitrary or perverse, even though Vedanta had claimed its offer was higher by about ₹3,400 crore in gross value and around ₹500 crore in net present value terms, it said.

Adani Enterprises had placed a ₹14,535-crore bid for the bankrupt infrastructure giant and it was approved by the NCLT in March.

While accepting Vedanta's petition for hearing, the NCLAT refused to grant an interim stay on the NCLT order, while noting that the resolution would remain subject to the outcome of the appeals. The Supreme Court also refused to stay NCLAT decision, but ordered to execute the deal only after hearing Vedanta's appeal.

Tata Chem posts ₹2,116 cr Q4 loss on impairment charges, weak soda ash prices

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Tata Chemicals on Monday reported a sharp widening of consolidated net loss to ₹2,116 crore in the January-March period of FY26, weighed down by a ₹1,837-crore goodwill impairment charge in the US and weak soda ash prices across geographies.

Net loss stood at ₹49 crore a year earlier, according to a regulatory filing. The company booked an exceptional charge of ₹1,837 crore for goodwill impairment in its US operations and wrote off ₹182 crore in deferred tax assets, citing deteriorating soda ash export market conditions.

Revenue from operations fell 2 per cent to ₹3,438 crore (₹3,509 crore), while total expenses rose to ₹3,660 crore (₹3,612 crore).

EBITDA declined to ₹274

Revenue from operations fell 2 per cent to ₹3,438 crore, while total expenses rose to ₹3,660 crore

crore (₹327 crore), hurt by subdued pricing across all geographies and higher fixed costs, partly driven by a steep depreciation of the Indian rupee.

The company's MD and CEO, R Mukundan, said global soda ash markets remained adequately supplied during the quarter, with the supply overhang continuing to pressure pricing. "The challenging external environment amid ongoing geopolitical tensions in West Asia led to uncertainty and limited visibility on any immediate change in market conditions," he said.

Godrej Properties posts 32% growth in net profit at ₹1,850 crore in FY26

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Godrej Properties reported a strong set of numbers for the March quarter, with consolidated net profit rising 70 per cent year-on-year to ₹650 crore in Q4 FY26, driven by robust project deliveries and sustained demand across key markets.

Revenue from operations rose 63 per cent to ₹3,458 crore, while EBITDA increased 51 per cent to ₹959 crore.

In an analyst call, the management said the first half of FY27 was looking bright due to a strong launch pipeline.

FY26 NUMBERS

For FY26, the company posted a 32 per cent rise in net profit at ₹1,850 crore, with revenue growing 4 per cent to ₹5,131.4 crore.

Adjusted EBITDA climbed 37 per cent to ₹2,957 crore, reflecting strong operating leverage amid higher scale.



Operationally, the developer delivered record performance across key metrics. Booking value rose 16 per cent to ₹34,171 crore, while collections increased 17 per cent to ₹19,965 crore. Operating cash flow stood at ₹7,830 crore.

The company also reported its highest-ever quarterly bookings in Q4 at ₹10,163 crore.

In terms of guidance versus actual performance, Godrej Properties exceeded or met most of its FY26 tar-

gets, with bookings and launch value surpassing guidance.

Deliveries significantly outperformed at 121 per cent of guidance, and business development overshoot expectations sharply at 211 per cent. However, collections came in slightly below target at 95 per cent of guidance.

For FY27, it is targeting booking value of ₹39,000 crore, collections of ₹24,000 crore, and launch value of ₹48,000 crore. Deliveries are expected to reach 13.5 million sq ft, while business development guidance has been set at ₹20,000 crore.

businessline.

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(Please scan this QR code to view the Offer Document)



BAGMANE PRIME OFFICE REIT

(Registered in the Republic of India as a contributory, determinate and irrevocable trust on May 30, 2025 at Bengaluru, Karnataka, India under the Indian Trusts Act, 1882 and as a real estate investment trust on July 15, 2025 at Mumbai, Maharashtra, India under the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Real Estate Investment Trusts) Regulations, 2014, as amended having registration number IN/REIT25-26/0007)

Principal Place of Business: 5th Floor, 'B' Block, Laurel Building, C.V. Raman Nagar, Bagmane Tech Park, Bengaluru - 560 093, Karnataka, India, Tel: +91 80 4032 9901; Fax: N.A.; Compliance Officer: Venkatesh Ranganath P; E-mail: reitcompliance@bagmanereit.com; Website: www.bagmanereit.com

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- Non-Institutional Investor Portion : Not less than 25% of the Offer (excluding Strategic Investor Portion)
- Strategic Investor Portion : Not less than 5% of the Offer and not more than 25% of the Offer

Price Band: ₹95 to ₹100 per Unit
Bids can be made for a minimum of 150 Units and in multiples of 150 Units thereafter by Bidders (other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors)

Risks to Investors:

- Bagmane REIT does not provide any assurance or guarantee of any distributions to the Unitholders. It may not be able to make distributions to Unitholders in the manner described in the Offer Document or at all, and the level of distributions may decrease.
- The Bagmane REIT has a limited operating history and may not be able to operate its business successfully or generate sufficient cash flows to make or sustain distributions.
- The Special Purpose Combined Financial Statements are prepared for the Offer Document and may not necessarily be representative of the Bagmane REIT's actual consolidated financial position, results of operation and cash flows for such periods.

Credit Rating: As on December 26, 2025, the Bagmane REIT has been assigned an issuer rating of Provisional CARE AAA; Stable by CARE Ratings Limited and as on December 29, 2025, the Bagmane REIT has been assigned an issuer rating of Provisional [ICRA] AAA (Stable) by ICRA Limited

BID/OFFER PROGRAM[#]

BID/OFFER OPENS TODAY

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON: THURSDAY, MAY 07, 2026

[#]The Offer also includes participation by Strategic Investors in accordance with the SEBI REIT Master Circular.

ASBA[#] Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!	[#] Applications supported by blocked amount (ASBA) is a better way of applying to issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.	 UNITED PAYMENTS INTERFACE	For individual Non-Institutional Investors using UPI Mechanism, the Stock Exchanges shall share the bid details (including UPI ID) with Sponsor Bank on a continuous basis to enable the Sponsor Bank to initiate UPI Mandate Request to individual Non-Institutional Investors for blocking of funds. The Sponsor Bank shall initiate request for blocking of funds through NPCI to individual Non-Institutional Investors, who shall accept the UPI Mandate Request for blocking of funds on their respective mobile applications associated with UPI ID linked bank account.
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In case of any revision to the Price Band, the Bid/ Offer Period will be extended by at least one Working Day, and in case of force majeure, banking strike or similar circumstances, for reasons to be recorded in writing, the Bid/ Offer Period will be extended for a minimum period of three Working Days, subject to the total Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 30 days, provided that there shall not be more than two revisions to the Price Band during the Bid/ Offer Period. The revised Price Band and Bid/ Offer Period will be widely disseminated by notification to the Designated Intermediaries and Stock Exchanges, and also by indicating the change on the websites of the Bagmane REIT, the BRLMs, the Sponsor, the Manager and the Stock Exchanges and at the terminals of the members of the Syndicate.

The Offer is being made through the Book Building Process and in compliance with the REIT Regulations and the SEBI Master Circular, wherein not more than 75% of the Offer (excluding Strategic Investor Portion) shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Institutional Investors, provided that the Manager may, in consultation with the Selling Unitholder and BRLMs, allocate up to 60% of the Institutional Investor Portion to Anchor Investors on a proportionate basis in accordance with the REIT Regulations and the SEBI REIT Master Circular. Further, not less than 25% of the Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Non-Institutional Investors (excluding the Strategic Investor Portion), in accordance with the REIT Regulations and the SEBI REIT Master Circular, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. The Manager, in consultation with the Selling Unitholder and BRLMs, may retain oversubscription in the Offer in accordance with the REIT Regulations and the SEBI Master Circular. All Bidders, other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors, are required to utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID (in case of individual Non-Institutional Investors using the UPI Mechanism. Bidding with a Bid Amount of ₹ 500,000 or less), in which case the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("SCSBs") or under the UPI Mechanism, as applicable, to participate in this Offer. For details, see "Offer Procedure" on page 417 of the Offer Document.

Bidders should note that on the basis of Bidders' PAN, DP ID, UPIID (for individual Non-Institutional Investors Bidding for a Bid Amount of ₹0.50 million or less using the UPI Mechanism) and Client ID provided by them in the Bid cum Application Form and as entered into the electronic bidding system of the Stock Exchanges by the Designated Intermediaries as the case may be, the Registrar will obtain from the Depository the demographic details including the Bidders' address, occupation and bank account details including the nine-digit magnetic ink character recognition ("MICR") code as appearing on the cheque leaf ("Demographic Details"), from the Depository. The Demographic Details will be used for giving refunds and allocation advice (including through physical refund warrants, direct credit, NACH, NEFT and RTGS) to the Bidders. Hence, Bidders are advised to immediately update their bank account details, PAN and Demographic Details as appearing on the records of the Depository Participant and ensure that they are true and correct. Failure to do so could result in delays in dispatch/credit of refunds to Bidders at the Bidders sole risk and none of the BRLMs, the Registrar, the Escrow Collection Banks, the Sponsor Bank, the SCSBs, the Manager or the Trustee will have any responsibility or undertake any liability for this. Accordingly, Bidders should carefully fill in their depository account details in the Bid cum Application Form.

By signing the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder is deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar, on request, the required Demographic Details as available in their records.

Bids with no corresponding record available with the Depositories matching the three parameters (namely, Bidders PAN (in case of joint Bids, PAN of First Bidder), the DP ID, the UPI ID (for individual Non-Institutional Investors Bidding for a Bid Amount of ₹500,000 or less using the UPI Mechanism) and Client ID), are liable to be rejected.

Listing: The Units are proposed to be listed on BSE Limited ("BSE") and National Stock Exchange of India Limited ("NSE", together with BSE, the "Stock Exchanges"). The Bagmane REIT has received in-principle approvals from the Stock Exchanges for listing of our Units pursuant to letters each dated February 13, 2026. NSE is the Designated Stock Exchange for the Offer.

SEBI Disclaimer : It is to be distinctly understood that submission of the Draft Offer Document, the Offer Document or the Final Offer Document to SEBI should not in any way be deemed or construed that the same has been cleared or approved by SEBI. SEBI does not take any responsibility either for the financial soundness of any scheme or the project for which the Offer is proposed to be made or for the correctness of the statements made or opinions expressed in the Draft Offer Document, the Offer Document and the Final Offer Document.

NSE Disclaimer (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to the Offer Document for the full text of the "Disclaimer clause of NSE" on page 9 of the Offer Document.

BSE Disclaimer: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE Limited should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by BSE Limited nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to the Offer Document for the full text of the "Disclaimer clause of the BSE" on page 9 of the Offer Document.

General Risks: Investments in the Units involves a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Prospective investors are advised to read the "Risk Factors" on page 48 of the Offer Document carefully before taking an investment decision with respect to the Offer. For taking such investment decision, prospective investors must rely on their own examination of the Bagmane REIT and the Offer including the risks involved. Each prospective investor is advised to consult its own advisors in respect of the consequences of an investment in the Units being issued pursuant to the Offer Document. The Draft Offer Document and the Offer Document have been prepared by the Manager solely for providing information in connection with the Offer and a copy of the Offer Document has been delivered to Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") and the Stock Exchanges. However, the Units have not been recommended or approved by SEBI and the Stock Exchanges and nor do SEBI or the Stock Exchanges guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of any statements made, opinions expressed or reports contained herein and accordingly, admission of the Units to be allotted pursuant to the Offer for trading on the Stock Exchanges should not be taken as an indication of the merits of the Bagmane REIT or of the Units.

NOTICE TO THE INVESTORS - CORRIGENDUM						
The ISIN of Bagmane Prime Office REIT (acting through its Manager, i.e., Bagmane Realty Investment Manager Private Limited) ("Bagmane REIT") included in the bid cum application forms shall be read as "INE2OVN25015" instead of "IN2OVN25015", and the latter has been mentioned inadvertently. Further, Bagmane REIT will reflect the ISIN as INE2OVN25015 in the allotment advice cum refund intimation to be dispatched to Bidders.						
BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS						
JM Financial Limited 7 th Floor, Cynergy Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi Mumbai - 400 025 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 6630 3030 E-mail: bagmane.reit@jmfml.com Investor grievance e-mail: grievance.idb@jmfml.com Website: www.jmfml.com Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361	Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited 1 st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. 27, G Block Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4336 0000 E-mail: bagmane.reit@kotak.com Investor grievance e-mail: kmcaddressal@kotak.com Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com Contact Person: Ganesh Rane SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704	Axis Capital Limited Axis House, 1 st Floor Pandurang Budhkar Marg Worli, Mumbai - 400 025 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4325 2183 E-mail: bagmanereit.ip@axiscap.in Investor Grievance e-mail: complaints@axiscap.in Website: www.axiscapital.co.in Contact Person: Pratik Pednekar / Tosit Aganwal SEBI Registration No.: INM000010209	IIFL Capital Services Limited (Formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited) 24 th Floor, One Lodha Place Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4646 4728 E-mail: bagmanereit.ip@iiflcap.com Investor Grievance e-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com Website: www.iiflcapital.com Contact Person: Yogesh Malpani / Pawan Kumar Jain SEBI Registration No.: INM000010940	SBI Capital Markets Limited 1501, 15 th Floor, A&B Wing, Parinee Crescenzo Building, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4006 9807 E-mail: bagmane.reit@sbicaps.com Investor Grievance e-mail: investorrelations@sbicaps.com Website: www.sbicaps.com Contact Person: Raghavendra Bhat / Aditya Deshpande SEBI Registration No.: INM000003531	360 ONE WAM Limited 360 ONE Centre, Kamala City Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4031 7000 Email: bagmanegroup.ip@360.one Investor Grievance e-mail: mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one Website: https://www.360.one Contact Person: Devesh Patkar SEBI Registration No.: INM000012801	HDFC Bank Limited Investment Banking Group Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7 th floor Tower 2 and 3, One International Centre Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 3395 8233 E-mail: bagmane.reit@hdfcbank.com Investor Grievance e-mail: Investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com Website: www.hdfc.bank.in Contact Person: Gaurav Khandelwal / Souradeep Ghosh SEBI Registration No.: INM000011252
REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER				COMPLIANCE OFFICER		
 KFin Technologies Limited Selenium Tower B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally, Hyderabad, Ranga Reddi - 500 032, Telangana, India Tel: +91 40 6716 2222/1800 309 4001, E-mail: bagmane.reit@kfintech.com, Investor grievance e-mail: einward.ris@kfintech.com Website: www.kfintech.com, Contact Person: M. Murali Krishna, SEBI Registration No.: INR000002221				Venkatesh Ranganath P Tel: +91 80 4032 9901, Fax: N.A. E-mail: reitcompliance@bagmanereit.com Website: www.bagmanereit.com		
				Bidders can contact the Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related issues such as non-receipt of Allotment/Adverse/letter of Allotment, credit of Allotted Units in the respective beneficiary account, refund orders and non-receipt of funds by electronic mode.		

AVAILABILITY OF THE OFFER DOCUMENT: Investors are advised to refer to the Offer Document and the "Risk Factors" section on page 48 of the Offer Document, contained therein before applying in the Offer. The Offer Document is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, BSE at www.bseindia.com, NSE at www.nseindia.com and at the websites of the Book Running Lead Managers, i.e. JM Financial Limited, Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Axis Capital Limited, IIFL Capital Services Limited (Formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited), SBI Capital Markets Limited, 360 ONE WAM Limited and HDFC Bank Limited at www.jmfml.com, https://investmentbank.kotak.com, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.iiflcapital.com, www.sbicaps.com, https://www.360.one and www.hdfc.bank.in, respectively, and at the website of Bagmane Prime Office REIT at www.bagmanereit.com.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Bid-cum-Application Forms can be obtained from the principal place of business of Bagmane Prime Office REIT, Tel: +91 80 4032 9901; at the offices of the Book Running Lead Managers : JM Financial Limited, Tel: +91 22 6630 3030; Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Tel: +91 22 4336 0000; Axis Capital Limited, Tel: +91 22 4325 2183; IIFL Capital Services Limited (Formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited), Tel: +91 22 4646 4728; SBI Capital Markets Limited, Tel: +91 22 4006 9807; 360 ONE WAM Limited, Tel: +91 22 4031 7000; and HDFC Bank Limited, Tel: +91 22 3395 8233, Syndicate Members: JM Financial Services Limited, Tel: +91 22 6136 3400; Kotak Securities Limited, Tel: +91 22 6218 5410; SBICAP Securities Limited, Tel: 91-22-69316411; Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited, Tel: +91 9619551014; HDFC Securities Limited, Tel: +91 22 3075 3400; 360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited, Tel: +91 22 4031 7070 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members, SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Offer, Bid-cum-Application Forms will also be available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

APPLICATIONS SUPPORTED BY BLOCKED AMOUNT (ASBA): Investors other than Anchor Investors have to apply through the ASBA process. For details on the ASBA process, please refer to the details given in the ASBA Form and the Offer Document and also please refer to the section entitled "Offer Procedure" beginning on page 417 of the Offer Document. ASBA Forms can also be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges. ASBA form can be obtained from the list of banks that is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in. ASBA Forms can be obtained from Members of the Syndicate, Registered Brokers from list provided on the websites of the BSE and

the NSE at http://www.bseindia.com and http://www.nseindia.com, respectively, RTAs and CDPs from the list provided on the websites of Stock Exchanges at http://www.bseindia.com and https://www.nseindia.com, respectively.

Sub-syndicate Members: Almondz Global Securities Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rath Share & Stock Broker, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Private Limited, Equirus Securities Private Limited, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd., Finwizard Technology Private Limited, Fisdom Technology, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Delhi, ICICI Securities, IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Limited, IIFL Capital Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd., Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaven Securities, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Private Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd., Keynote Capitals Limited, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, KJMC Financial Services Limited, Lakshmeshree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Manwadi Shares & Finance, Monaroh Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Ltd., Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Ltd., Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Pravin Ratilal Sheredalal, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities, Rikhav Securities Ltd., RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, Sharekhan Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Sundhi Securities & Finance Ltd., Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls, Unistone Capital Pvt Ltd, Upstock Pvt Ltd, Wealth First Biz, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha.

Escrow Collection Bank, Sponsor Bank, Refund Bank and Public Offer Bank Account : Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited; Escrow Collection Bank, Sponsor Bank and Refund Bank: Axis Bank Limited

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the Offer Document.

Place : Bengaluru, Karnataka
Date : May 4, 2026

BAGMANE PRIME OFFICE REIT, acting through its Investment Manager, is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial offer of its Units representing an undivided beneficial interest in Bagmane Prime Office REIT, and has filed the Offer Document with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges on April 27, 2026. The Offer Document is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, BSE at www.bseindia.com, NSE at www.nseindia.com, respectively, as well as on the website of the Book Running Lead Managers, i.e. JM Financial Limited, Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Axis Capital Limited, IIFL Capital Services Limited (Formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited), SBI Capital Markets Limited, 360 ONE WAM Limited and HDFC Bank Limited at www.jmfml.com, https://investmentbank.kotak.com, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.sbicaps.com, https://www.360.one and www.hdfc.bank.in, respectively, and at the website of the Bagmane Prime Office REIT at www.bagmanereit.com. Potential investors should note that investment in the Units involves a degree of risk, and for details relating to the same, should refer to the section "Risk Factors" on page 48 of the Offer Document. These materials are not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. These materials are not an offer for the sale of the Units or other securities in the United States or elsewhere.

The Units have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the "Securities Act") and may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the Securities Act and applicable U.S. state securities laws. Bagmane Realty Investment Manager Private Limited, acting as manager of Bagmane Prime Office REIT (the "REIT") does not intend to register any of the securities of the REIT in the United States or to conduct a public offering of the securities of the REIT in the United States.





I extend my congratulations to Thiru Vijay on his spectacular victory in the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections

N CHANDRABABU NAIDU
Chief Minister, Andhra Pradesh



I bow to people's verdict... DMK's political journey will continue without any slackness

M K STALIN
DMK President



Happy to see in my land, people have risen in one voice and spoken — no to buying of votes and no to dynastic politics

K ANNAMALAI
BJP leader



I bow to the people of West Bengal for choosing progress over fear. Together, we shall rebuild West Bengal

SUVENDU ADHIKARI
BJP leader



This victory has been a vote for development, Nari Shakti, identity and the vision of a Viksit Assam

HIMANTA BISWA SARMA
Chief Minister, Assam

Fall of a fortress: BJP sweeps West Bengal

LANDSLIDE WIN. End of 15-year Trinamool Congress rule marks a watershed moment for the saffron party

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

Riding on a massive anti-incumbency wave against the Mamata-Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress government, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Monday recorded a historic landslide victory in the West Bengal Assembly elections and was heading towards forming its government in the eastern State for the first time.

The BJP's win ends 15-year of TMC rule and marks a watershed moment for the saffron party as it dismantled Banerjee's bastion through an all-gun blazing election campaign led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah.

BIPOLAR CONTEST

The political contest remained bipolar as BJP won 156 seats and was leading in 52 seats out of the total 294-seats (as of 8:50 p.m. on May 4) Assembly, decimating mighty TMC to a two-digit figure. Trinamool could only win 55 seats and was leading in just 24 constituencies in the State, which voted in favour of "Parivartan".

BJP's vote share rose to 45.71 per cent from 37.97 per cent in 2021 Assembly elections, while that of Trinamool Congress fell to 40.82 per cent from 48.02 per cent, according to the Election

Commission data. The Congress and Humayun Kabir's Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) won two seats each, while CPI(M) won one seat. The CPI(M)-led Left fought this election in an alliance with the ISF and the CPI (ML) Liberation. ISF was leading in one seat. During the last assembly election in 2021, the BJP won 77 seats, while the Trinamool Congress won in 215 constituencies in the 294 West Bengal Assembly.

SIR EFFECT

In the aftermath of the massive deletion of voters during the controversial Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Bengal, the State witnessed record voter turnouts in both the first and second phases of the high-stakes Assembly elections on April 23 and April 29, respectively.

"BJP registered a decisive victory in West Bengal as voters voted against Trinamool Congress' alleged corruption and non-governance during its 15-year rule. While Hindu votes consolidated in favour of BJP, Muslim voters, apart from voting to TMC, voted in favour of Congress, Humayun Kabir's Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) and CPI-M in the minority-dominated constituencies. The multiparty fight in those seats resulted in BJP winning some seats



COLOUR OF VICTORY. BJP supporters started celebrations with *gula* even as the trends started coming in on Monday in Kolkata

and putting the candidates in a great position. Also, top BJP leadership campaigned strongly for its candidates across the State," political analyst Subhamoy Maitra told *businessline*.

"Also, there was a myth in Bengal politics over the necessity of a strong organisational structure for a party as here polls were hardly held in a free and fair manner. BJP observed that the party has been winning seats in spite of its weak organisational structure in the state. So, they have taken the path to ensure free, fair, and peaceful elections through the Election Commission and the Central government to

come to power," Maitra pointed out.

Significantly, the BJP's election campaigns focussed on major issues like Trinamool Congress government's several alleged corruption, RG Kar Hospital rape-murder case, poor law and order situation, and women safety.

SIX GUARANTEES

Narendra Modi unveiled "six guarantees" for Bengal, promising an accountable administration and action against corruption if the BJP comes to power in the State.

The Trinamool Congress government has faced a major uproar against the alleged

primary school teachers and secondary school teachers recruitment scams, in which thousands of teachers lost their jobs following court orders. Bengal also saw massive protests against the rape and murder of a young doctor in State-run RG Kar hospital.

The TMC government also faced the wrath of voters due to its "failure" to create enough jobs for the youths and women, and also its inability to bring in big ticket investment. In a major setback to the party, over 20 ministers, including outgoing Education Minister Bratya Basu, Women and Child Development Minister

Shashi Panja and Finance Minister Chandrima Bhat-tacharya, either lost the high-stakes elections or were trailing. Among heavyweight BJP leaders, Suvendu Adhikari, the outgoing Leader of Opposition in the Assembly, was ahead by over 8700 votes in Nandigram after 11 rounds of counting. While BJP leader Dilip Ghosh was leading by 14,195 votes after 15 rounds in his Kharagpur Sadar constituency, Swapan Dasgupta was ahead by 8,657 votes against his nearest competitor Debasish Kumar of TMC after 10 rounds of counting.

Although the BJP did not announce any Chief Ministerial face for Bengal during the long election campaign, according to political observers any one of the big three — Suvendu Adhikari, Swapan Dasgupta and Dilip Ghosh may come up as the top candidate.

Political observers pointed out that in the Minority-dominated districts like Murshidabad and Malda, which saw massive voter deletion during the SIR exercise of electoral rolls, anti-incumbency factors outweighed consolidation of Muslim votes, and as a result, parties like Congress and Humayun Kabir's Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) and CPI(M) received major vote share in some constituencies.

Saffron wave

West Bengal elections: Key candidates

Figures in parenthesis denote margins of victory or defeat

Bhabanipur	Nandigram	Kharagpur Sadar
 Mamata Banerjee (AITC) Vs Suvendu Adhikari (BJP) 48,414 votes	 Suvendu Adhikari (BJP) Vs Pabitra Kar (AITC) 1,12,642 votes	 Dilip Ghosh (BJP) Vs Pradip Sarkar (AITC) 52,606 votes
 Minakshi Mukherjee (CPIM) Vs Dipanjana Chakraborty (BJP) 73,262 votes	 Subhankar Sarkar (INC) Vs Bhaskar Bhattacharya (BJP) 85,644 votes	

Source: ECI As of 19:30

NDA crosses halfway mark in Puducherry

Asia News International
Puducherry

The National Democratic Alliance (NDA) is set to retain power in the Union Territory of Puducherry. As counting continued on Monday, the alliance, led by Chief Minister N Rangasamy, had already surged past the majority threshold, leading in or having won 17 seats in the 30-member Assembly.

The All India NR Congress (AINRC) remains the powerhouse of the alliance, securing 11 seats (9 wins, 2 leads).

With the halfway mark set at 16, the NDA's performance

ensures a stable path to forming the next government before the current assembly term expires on June 15. Following closely is the DMK, with two wins and three more seats in the lead, totalling five seats. The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) also made its presence felt, winning two seats and leading in two others, bringing its total to four.

Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), though not a major contender, secured two wins, while the Indian National Congress has claimed one seat.

The halfway mark in this election is set at 16 seats.

BJP candidates win with huge margins

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The scale of the Bharatiya Janata Party's victory in West Bengal is underlined not just by seats won, but by the sheer margins it secured across constituencies, pointing to a deep and broad-based shift in voter alignment.

Among the standout results, BJP's Anandamay Barman emerged as the election's star performer, winning the Matigara-Naxalbari (25) seat by a margin of over 1 lakh votes, defeating Shankar Malakar of the All India Trinamool Congress.

The result is emblematic of a wider trend. Of the BJP's 146 winning candidates, as

many as 105 out of 119 secured victory margins exceeding 10,000 votes, while only two candidates scraped through with margins of less than 1,000 votes.

Even some of the party's most prominent faces were not immune to tighter contests.

Senior BJP leader Suvendu Adhikari won from Nandigram by a margin of less than 10,000 votes after all 19 rounds of counting, according to Election Commission data. As of 8.40 pm, the BJP had won 146 seats, with 62 candidates still leading.

High-margin victories were recorded across the State. In Dabgram-Fulbari, BJP's Sikha Chatterjee won by 97,715 votes, polling 1,66,300 votes. Other significant

wins in the 70,000-90,000 margin range included Tarak Nath Chatterjee from Krishnanagar Uttar (83), Joyel Murmu from Habibpur (43), and Utpal Brahmachari from Kaliaganj (34).

A further eight candidates, including Nishith Pramanik, Ashim Kumar Biswas, Sukanta Biswas and Gopal Chandra Saha, won by margins between 50,000 and 70,000 votes.

In addition, 31 BJP candidates registered margins in the 30,000-50,000 bracket, while 59 candidates won by margins between 10,000 and 30,000 votes.

Actor-turned-politician Rupa Ganguly won the Sonarpur Dakshin seat by over 35,000 votes.

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi celebrated "Anga-Banga-Kalinga" — a reference to three ancient kingdoms that today roughly correspond to Bihar, West Bengal, and Odisha where the BJP is now in power — during his election victory speech on Monday evening, asserting that the transformation in the three eastern States is crucial for "Viksit Bharat".

Wearing Bengali *dhoti* and *kurta*, Modi hailed the BJP's empathic win in West Bengal polls ending 15-year-long rule of TMC as a verdict which marked its "faith in democracy and the politics of performance". Delving into the historical economic and cultural context that made Anga, Banga and Kalinga triangle of development, Modi expressed his gratitude to the people for choosing BJP to transform



BIG WIN. Prime Minister Narendra Modi felicitating BJP National President Nitin Nabin after the party's win in West Bengal, Assam and Puducherry, at the party headquarters in New Delhi. Union Ministers Amit Shah, Rajnath Singh and JP Nadda were also present

Bihar, West Bengal and Odisha so that they can contribute to the national vision of developed country by 2047.

He recalled that after the Bihar's assembly elections results came out on November 14, 2025, retaining the NDA government in the state, he had said that

"Ganga flows from Bihar to Gangasagar (in West Bengal)", hinting that the party was committed to fighting out the Mamata government — a formidable political opponent.

Referring to violence in Bengal during polls, he urged workers of all political parties to end the "endless

cycle of violence once and for all".

"Today, when the BJP has won, the focus should be on change, not revenge. The focus should be on the future, not fear. I appeal to the workers of all political parties: let's end this endless cycle of violence once and for all," he said.

Referring to the BJP ideology, Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had founded Jan Sangh, the PM said that Syama Prasad Mookerjee hailed from Bengal and it is the first time that the BJP will form a government in the State.

"Today, as a BJP worker, another thought keeps coming to my mind. The soul of Dr Syama Prasad Mookerjee must be at so much peace today."

He also said that women will be safe in Bengal and youth will get employment and repeated the vow that strict action will be taken against the infiltrators.

"I want to assure every citizen of Bengal that BJP will work relentlessly for the better future of Bengal. Now, in Bengal, women will be safe, youths will get employment, and migration will stop. In the first Cabinet meeting, the Ayushman Yojana will be cleared...And strict action will be taken against the infiltrators," he said.

Mamata loses high-stakes battle against Suvendu Adhikari in Bhabanipur

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee exhorted party leaders and workers last Saturday, claiming that the Trinamool Congress was coming to power for the fourth consecutive time by winning more than 200 seats, accusing the BJP of misleading the people with "fictitious" exit poll results.

Even on Monday afternoon when the trends in the Assembly elections showed the saffron party surging ahead, she struck a defiant note. Releasing a video message on X titled 'Urgent Message', she appealed to the party's counting agents and candidates, asking them to remain vigilant and not lose hope despite early setbacks. "Requesting everyone not to leave the counting centres... they will show where BJP will lead... stay at the counting centre," she



SHOCKING DEFEAT. West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee speaking to the media in Kolkata

said, alleging that initial rounds may be skewed. Banerjee has always been a street fighter, even when her party recorded a historic loss against arch rival BJP.

"I want to tell our counting agents, don't feel bad. Fight is not over yet. Wait and watch," she added.

As the day progressed, Bengal saw the outgoing Chief Minister's fortress crumble. Moreover, the high-voltage contest at Bhabanipur Assembly seat turned on its head, with

Banerjee slipping behind BJP's Suvendu Adhikari after sharp swings, capping a steady erosion of her early lead in one of the State's most closely watched battles.

Eventually, she lost the battle. After 17 rounds of counting, Banerjee was trailing by 6226 votes, polling 54,728 votes against Adhikari's 60,954, according to Election Commission data. It's the second time Adhikari, once her close aide, defeated her. In 2021, Adhikari

defeated Banerjee in Nandigram in Purba Medinipur district by a slender margin of 1,956 votes.

However, Banerjee had led the Trinamool Congress to a sweeping victory State-wide and later re-entered the Assembly through a by-election in Bhabanipur, winning by a margin of 58,000 votes, reaffirming the seat as one of her strongest bastions. In the last Assembly elections, the BJP won 77 seats, while the Trinamool Congress won in 215 constituencies in the 294 West Bengal Assembly.

The BJP, however, drew confidence from the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, when the Trinamool Congress secured a relatively modest lead of 8,291 votes from the Bhabanipur Assembly segment amid allegations of corruption and signs of anti-incumbency.

Significantly, the saffron party this time breached South Bengal and Kolkata,

considered TMC's stronghold and heartland, ending the party's 15-year rule.

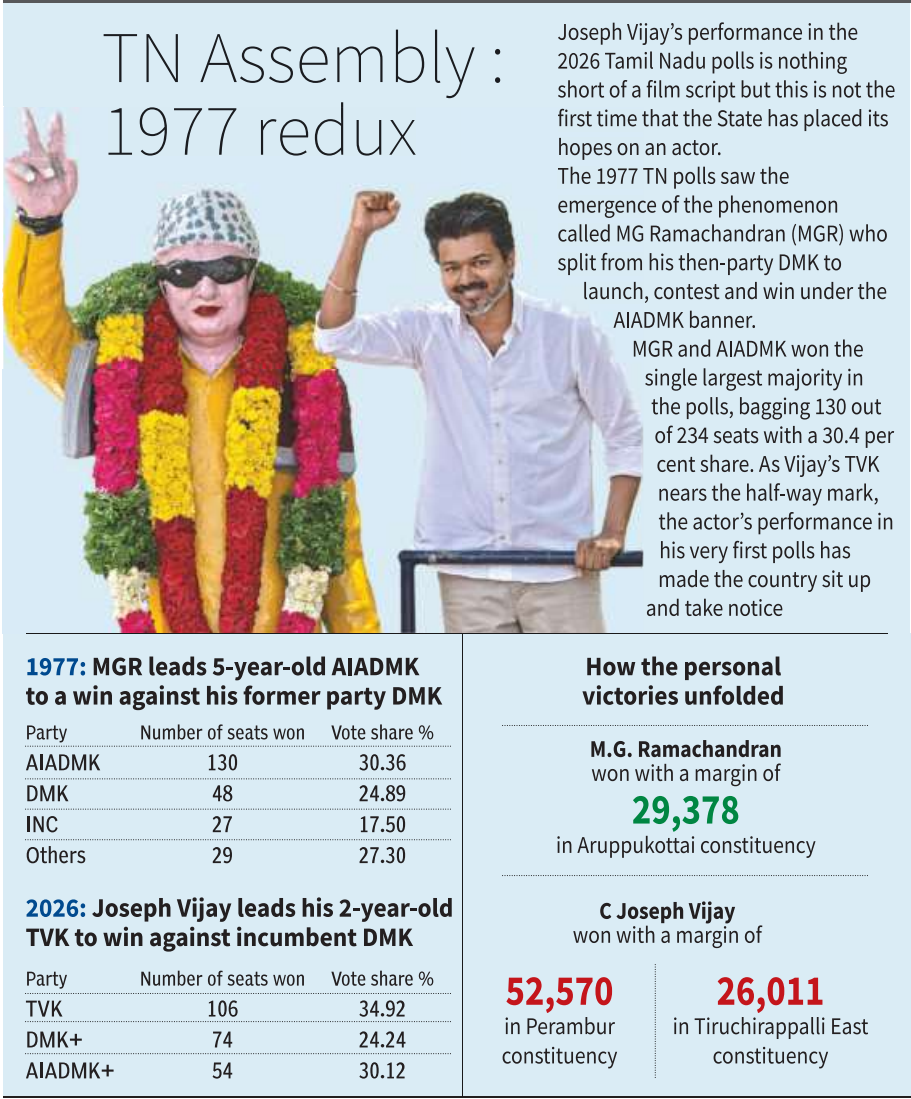
Riding on the strong anti-incumbency wave and major corruption allegations against Trinamool, the Opposition BJP has completely reversed its slide in Bengal in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections when it had led in 90 Assembly segments with a vote share of 38.7 per cent and won 12 seats.

Till the time of going to press, the BJP had secured a vote share of 45.76 per cent and was ahead or winning a whopping 207 seats in the total 293 seats for which elections were held. The incumbent TMC was at 80 seats with a vote share of 40.81 per cent, a steep fall from 45.8 per cent vote share it had garnered in 2024 Lok Sabha elections.

Trinamool Congress had registered a historic victory in West Bengal in 2011, ending the 34-year rule of the Left Front.

VISUALLY.

Compiled by **Sindhu Hariharan, Roshan Flavian** | Graphic **KS Gunasekar**



Source: ECI as of 8 pm



“The public have clearly voted for change, an end to ten years of LDF misgovernance and a bold new direction for Kerala

SHASHI THAROOR
Congress MP



“Under the great leadership of our Narendra Modi Ji, Bengal Rises. Stronger. Fearless. Unstoppable....This is just the beginning

LEANDER PAES
BJP leader



“Heartiest gratitude to the people of Puducherry for reposing their faith in the NDA under the leadership of PM @NarendraModi ji

PIYUSH GOYAL
Commerce Minister



“The euphoria is still settling in! Thrilled with the BJP win in Bengal — all the planning and hard work of Modi ji and Amit Shah ji has paid off!

HEMA MALINI
Actor



“Tamil Nadu has had its peaceful. Reformasi, Aragalaya, Arab Spring, July Uprising, and Jana Andolan III moment!

KARTI CHIDAMBARAM
Congress MP

UDF makes a spectacular comeback in Kerala

DECISIVE VERDICT. Coalition rides anti-incumbency wave to bag 102 of 140 seats, LDF a distant second with 35 seats

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

The UDF returned to power in Kerala with a massive mandate in the Assembly elections, clinching 102 seats of the 140 seats — a win that was reminiscent of the 2001 polls in the State when too the victor’s tally had crossed the 100 mark.

One key difference between now and 2001, however, is that then it was a fight between only the UDF and LDF while the 2026 battle heralded the entry of the BJP.

The LDF, which ruled the State for two consecutive tenures, was a distant second with just 35 seats, while the BJP got three seats — its best ever performance in Kerala.

ANTI-INCUMBENCY WAVE

The sweeping win by the UDF was achieved thanks to a strong anti-incumbency wave. Leader of the Opposition VD Satheesan emerged as principal architect of the UDF’s resurgence, combining tactical acuity with an issue-driven campaign to script a striking return to power.

His stewardship helped the front consolidate discon-

tent into a coherent mandate.

The BJP-led NDA raised its stakes materially in the State by clinching two seats in Thiruvananthapuram and adding a third in neighbouring Kollam. State president Rajeev Chandrasekhar prevailed from Nemon, while former Union Minister V Muraliedharan secured Kazhakkootam, both in Thiruvananthapuram district. The party broke new ground in the neighbouring Kollam district where BB Gopakumar captured the Chathannur seat, signalling a modest but symbolically significant expansion of its footprint.

The LDF suffered sweeping setbacks across key regions — from the northern bastions of Kannur and Kozhikode to Kollam in the south, signalling a broad-based erosion of support. In a dramatic repudiation, as many as 10 Ministers failed to make it to the 140-member Assembly.

The mood of the electorate was perhaps most vividly captured in Dharmadam, long considered a stronghold, where Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan trailed in the first five rounds of count-



HISTORIC RESURGENCE. Senior Congress leaders KC Venugopal, Shashi Tharoor, Ramesh Chennithala, Kodikunnil Suresh and Leader of the Opposition VD Satheesan celebrate the UDF’s victory in Thiruvananthapuram on Monday NIRMAL HARINDRAN

ing before recovering ground.

CHALLENGES AHEAD

However, for the UDF, the harder challenge begins now. Winning the election may prove easier than governing. Its first test is internal: Choosing a Chief Minister without triggering factional backlash. Satheesan, KC Venugopal and Ramesh Chennithala represent competing power centres, and

the choice will shape the balance of power within the Congress. Coalition management will be equally delicate. The Congress must accommodate allies such as the Indian Union Muslim League and the Kerala Congress factions while distributing key portfolios without destabilising the front.

Beyond that lies the real test of governance: Managing a fiscally strained State burdened by debt, welfare

commitments, unemployment and bureaucratic inertia. The UDF has won a decisive mandate for change. Converting it into a stable government is the challenge that now begins.

Post the win, Ramesh Chennithala, chairman of the Assembly Election Campaign Committee, said that the UDF will move forward with a greater sense of responsibility in line with the aspirations and expectations

of the people.

“We fought this election with a positive agenda which has been accepted by the people. It is not just a verdict against the misdeeds of the Pinarayi Vijayan government, but also an endorsement of the constructive vision we presented,” he said in a statement.

Chennithala pointed out that the five guarantees announced by Rahul Gandhi had a significant impact on the election outcome.

VOTER TURNOUT

Voter turnout was high at around 79 per cent, suggesting strong public engagement and possibly reflecting the intensity of anti-incumbency sentiment.

There was a visible swing among minority communities and sections of Hindu voters, contributing to a broader consolidation against the ruling front.

Overall, Kerala’s electorate appears to have delivered a decisive and structured verdict, driven primarily by State-level governance concerns, performance perceptions and leadership style, rather than aligning with broader national political trends.

Close contests and narrow win margins mark Kerala elections

Chitra Narayanan
New Delhi

The UDF may have scored a sweeping victory in Kerala with a 102 versus 35 verdict against the LDF, but on the ground, the contest was a really close one in several constituencies.

In at least 10 constituencies, the difference between a win and loss was less than 2,000 seats. In three cases, the margin of victory was less than 500 seats.

Take Manalur, where C Ravindranath of the CPI(M) just about edged past TN Prathapan of the IUML with a difference of merely 126 votes.

In the 2021 election in the same constituency, the LDF (CPI-M) had won by a margin of 29,876 votes. The difference this time was that BJP candidate KK Aneeskumar got a significant number of votes (38,125).

In Azhikode, KV Sumesh of the CPI (M) only narrowly edged past IUML’s Kareem Cheleri, the difference being just 349 votes. In the 2021 Assembly elections, KV Sumesh won the seat defeating KM Shaji of the IUML by a margin of 6,141 votes.

The narrow margin in 2026 could possibly be explained by the lower voter turnout. Azhikode reported a voter turnout of 73.99 per cent in the 2026 elections,



BJP leader V Muraliedharan joins celebrations following his victory from the Kazhakkootam seat

In at least 10 constituencies in Kerala, the difference between a win and loss was less than 2,000 seats. In three cases, the margin of victory was less than 500 seats

while it was 77.89 per cent in 2021.

In the much hyped battle for Kazhakkootam, where BJP’s Muraliedharan won over Kadamkampally Surendran of the CPI(M), the margin was just 428 votes. In 2021, Surendran had defeated BJP’s Shobha Surendran in this constituency.

In a show of power, voters boot out 13 Ministers in Kerala

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

Kerala’s Assembly elections once again reinforced people power in the State, as an angry electorate booted out the incumbent LDF government with a decisive mandate.

In a striking outcome, as many as 13 Ministers of the 21-member LDF Cabinet, led by Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, were defeated, signalling a clear rejection of its 10-year performance.

A widening disconnect between public sentiment and the party’s reading of it appears to have played a crucial role — an evident departure from an earlier era when seasoned leaders had a natural grasp of the electorate’s pulse.

dul Gafoor in Kalamassery in Ernakulam district. Health Minister Veena George lost from Aranmula. Education and Labour Minister V Sivankutty was defeated by BJP State President Rajeev Chandrasekhar in Nemon constituency. Transport Minister KB Ganesh Kumar was defeated by Congress candidate Jyothi Kumar Chammakala. Higher Education Minister R Bindu lost to Kerala Congress leader Thomas Unniyadan in Irinjalakuda.

A senior technocrat, speaking on the condition of anonymity, hinted at widespread governance underperformance, saying that several Ministers fell short of expectations. The scale of anti-incumbency revealed in surveys and exit polls remained largely undetected.

One of the key factors behind the rout of LDF was the stagnation of productive sectors. While welfare distribution remained strong, it failed to keep pace with the



DESERTED. A view of the Communist Party of India (Marxist) State headquarters in Thiruvananthapuram following the party-led Left Democratic Front’s defeat in the Kerala Assembly elections JAYAMOHAN A

aspirations of voters, he said.

Dominic Savio, political consultant and founder of Buzzstop Integrated Communications, said the outcome of the results shows that awareness has now evolved into evaluation, where the voter is no longer influenced by the umbrella of a party but is instead assessing each leader as a standalone offering.

“What has changed is the unit of decision making,

Earlier the voter chose the brand, today the voter is choosing the product within the brand”, he said.

Those Ministers — by definition are high-visibility products within the political brand — are expected to demonstrate performance, convert policy into experience, make governance tangible, and when they lose despite that visibility, it suggests a breakdown in perceived delivery.

“Visibility creates awareness. But awareness without outcome creates disappointment,” he added.

The defeat of high profile Ministers, including those seen as articulate and even future leadership material, reinforces this point, because it shows that perception without performance has a limited shelf life.

“In marketing, there is a USP (unique selling proposition). But in politics, the real USP is a unique selling problem, because the leader who identifies a problem sharply and positions himself as the most credible solution is the one who gets chosen.” In other words, politics is no longer about saying what you have done, it is about demonstrating what problem you are solving right now, he said.

Many Ministers in this election failed to establish that relevance clearly, either by not defining the problem strongly enough or by not

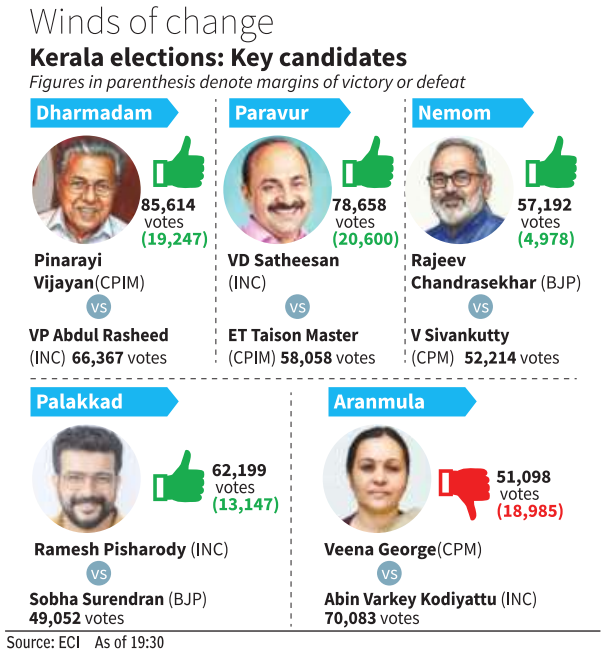
positioning themselves as the solution convincingly.

PERFORMANCE AUDIT

The defeat of 13 Ministers, therefore, is not just about anti-incumbency or political cycles. It is about a shift in how leadership is being perceived by ordinary voters. “Being in power is no longer a shield. It is a performance audit.”

Experts cautioned that the UDF’s victory comes with significant challenges. Fiscal management is likely to emerge as a major test, especially in a context where expectations are high and resources constrained.

Going forward, the State’s policy focus may need to shift towards wealth creation and optimal asset utilisation, an area where expectations are rising sharply. However, concerns over transparency and corruption have also surfaced, underlining the need for strong oversight and accountability.



Congress holds ground in Karnataka bypolls; wins Bagalkot, Davanagere South

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Riding on the momentum after the United Democratic Front’s win in Kerala, the Indian National Congress has added to its tally by retaining both key Karnataka bypoll seats.

The party held on to the Bagalkot and Davanagere South Assembly constituencies, where polling was held on April 9.

The bypolls were necessitated by the deaths of senior Congress MLAs HY Meti (Bagalkot) and Shamanur Shivashankarappa (Davanagere South), making the contests a matter of prestige for both the ruling Congress and the opposition BJP.

In Bagalkot, Umesh Meti, son of the late HY Meti has secured a decisive victory by a margin of 22,332 votes. After 23 rounds of counting, he polled 98,919 votes, comfortably ahead of BJP candidate Veeranna Charantimath, who received 76,587 votes.

Davanagere South, a long-

time Congress bastion, witnessed a closer contest. Samarth Shamanur Mallikarjun, grandson of the late Shivashankarappa, won by 5,708 votes after 24 rounds of counting, securing 69,578 votes against BJP’s Srinivasa Dasakariyappa, who garnered 63,870 votes. Social Democratic Party of India (SDPI)’s Afsar Kodlipete secured 18,975 votes and finished third.

CM Siddaramaiah said on X that the victory aligns with the government’s commitment to walk the talk, and ideological politics of the party.

VOTER TURNOUT

The voter turnout stood at 68.74 per cent in Bagalkot and 68.55 per cent in Davanagere South, as per ECI.

Political analyst Harish Ramaswamy said the Davanagere South result would be particularly reassuring for the Congress. “There was some anxiety around Davanagere, more than Bagalkot, but winning both is a bonus,” he said.

BJP continues winning streak in Assam, poised for third term

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Assam is heading towards a third consecutive term for the BJP-led NDA government with the Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma leading the party to its best-ever electoral performance since it unseated Congress to occupy power for the first time in the north-eastern State in 2016.

Riding on the BJP’s electoral dominance, visible in the party winning 65 seats and leading in 17 others, the NDA was set to cross the 100 mark in the 126-member assembly. Other NDA allies too were doing well — Bodoland People’s Front (BPF) won 7 seats and was leading in 3 more, and the Asom Gana Parishad (AGP) won 5 and was leading in the same number of other constituencies, as per the Election Commission of India (ECI).

Meanwhile, the Congress won 5 constituencies and was ahead in 14 more, down from 29 it secured in 2021 State polls. The biggest upset for Congress was its decision to field Gaurav Gogoi, an MP from the State, in the

State politics. He lost the Jorhat Assembly constituency to BJP’s Hitendra Nath Goswami, who polled 69,439 votes, winning by a margin of 23,182 votes.

HINDU VOTES

Even before the results for the entire 126 seats were declared by the ECI on Monday evening, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who campaigned extensively in the State, stated that Assam blesses BJP-NDA once again and thanked “sisters and brothers of Assam for the resounding mandate”.

“BJP-NDA’s win in Assam illustrates unwavering support for NDA’s emphasis on development, bringing positive change in people’s lives,” Modi posted on social media.

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma established a formidable lead of 89,434 votes over his nearest Congress rival Bidisha Neog in his traditional stronghold of Jalukbari constituency. But for facing defeat in his electoral debut in 1996, Sarma, the tallest BJP leader of North-East, has improved his winning streak from 2001, with his victory margin



HAT-TRICK WIN. Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma with State BJP president Dilip Saikia at the party headquarters in Guwahati on Monday PTI

going up in each poll, achieving a record winning margin of 1,01,000 in 2021.

Sarma, the Hindutva mascot of the northeastern States, joined in celebrations along with his party leaders and workers and said, “As long as Sun and Moon exist, India will remain Hindu nation”. He also continued his rant against Bangladeshi Muslims and vowed to fight their “aggression”.

The party has also increased its vote share to 38.17 per cent, which may go up as the counting was still on, if compared with 2024 Lok Sabha and 2021 as-

sembly elections. It got 37.43 per cent in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections and 33.21 per cent vote share in last assembly polls, the ECI data reveal. The positive swing in vote share is being referenced to extreme consolidation of the Hindu vote behind the BJP.

The political success is attributed to Sarma’s headline decisive leadership, his connect with people, and the BJP aggressively nurturing cultural polarisation through alliance with regional parties like AGP and BPF and re-drawing of boundaries through 2023 de-

limitation that structurally gave advantage to the indigenous population over migrant-origin minority groups.

This added to the identity and infiltrator narrative the party has been pursuing throughout its decade-long regime.

DELIMITATION EFFECT

The BJP is said to have fared well in the carefully crafted realigned seats. Like BJP candidate Jiban Gogoi, who jumped into the fray for the first time, won the newly created Sissibargaon constituency by a margin of 40,593 votes, having polled 75,758 votes in the contest against his nearest rival Dulal Chandra Boruah of the Rajar Dal, who managed 35,165 votes. Sissibargaon seat in Dhemaji district was created after the 2023 delimitation exercise.

Ahead of ECI’s delimitation exercise, the Assam NDA government in 2022 clubbed four newly created districts back into their parent districts — such as Hojai into Nagaon and Biswanath into Sonitpur — to check fragmentation of certain voter base the State wanted

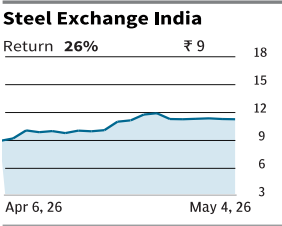
to protect, political observers stated. Against this backdrop, the Opposition failed to pose a formidable challenge, especially as it could not consolidate minority Muslim votes with Congress deciding to distance itself from the All India United Democratic Front (AIUDF), a prominent regional political party founded by Maulana Badruddin Ajmal. As a result, the Congress led a separate opposition bloc of Rajar Dal, Assam Jatiya Parishad, and CPI(M) — dividing votes which at many places turned out to be beneficial to the NDA candidates.

AIUDF, which faced the maximum heat of the delimitation of constituencies, registered a vote share of just 5.41 per cent with one win and leading in another seat. The Congress’ vote share is largely stable, from 29.67 per cent in 2021 after winning 29 seats to 29.51 per cent in 2026.

The Congress’ 18 of 19 Muslim candidates were leading in the electoral battle. Assam too saw a historic 85.91 per cent voter turnout, amplified due to record participation of 86.5 per cent women.

QUICKLY.

Steel Exchange raises ₹40.32 crore via warrants



Mumbai: Steel Exchange India Ltd announced a capital strengthening exercise, totalling ₹40.32 crore through warrants. The Visakhapatnam-based integrated steel maker allotted 4.4 crore convertible warrants on a preferential basis at ₹9.45 per warrant, raising ₹10.40 crore on receipt of 25 per cent of the subscription amount. Simultaneously, it converted 2.83 crore warrants, issued earlier at ₹14.10 per warrant, into shares after receiving the balance ₹29.92 crore. The proceeds will support operational expansion, improve working capital efficiency, and pursue strategic growth opportunities. **OUR BUREAU**

Simca Advertising plans ₹58 cr IPO on NSE-Emerge

Mumbai: Simca Advertising, an out-of-home advertising player, plans to raise ₹58 crore through initial public offering on the NSE Emerge platform. The company will issue 31,71,600 shares in the price band of ₹174-183 a share. It will open for subscription on May 8. Net proceeds from the IPO will be used for purchase and installation of LED screens, funding for strategic collaboration with Capital World Media Services for monetisation of 20 LED digital advertising screens and funding incremental working capital requirements. Anchor bidding will open on May 7. Socradamus Capital will be the Book Running lead manager. MUFG Intime India has been appointed as the registrar. **OUR BUREAU**

Nifty and Sensex surrender early gains as rupee continues to slide

FIRM FINISH. BJP’s emphatic win in 3 States, GST collections, robust auto sales buoy market sentiment

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The markets ended Monday on a positive note, but a sharp intra-day reversal and a record low rupee told a more cautious story.

The Nifty 50 closed at 24,119, up 121 points, after touching an intra-day high of 24,290 — gains that were nearly halved by midday selling before a partial late-session recovery. The Sensex settled at 77,269, adding 356 points.

The rally was driven by the BJP’s win in three of five State Assembly elections, GST collections, supportive global cues, cooling crude prices and strong April auto sales data.

Siddhartha Khemka, Head of Research, Wealth Management, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd, said the markets are expected to sustain their gradual upmove, with near-term direction anchored around three key drivers — softer crude oil prices, strong domestic data (record GST collection & healthy April auto sales growth), and political clarity post State election outcomes. “A BJP win in 3 out of five State Assembly elections is likely to reinforce political stability and provide a sentiment boost, while record GST collection and better-than-expected auto volume growth signals resilient underlying demand,” he added. The rupee fell for the fourth consecutive session,



POSITIVE MOOD. The broader markets outperformed, with the Midcap 100 up 0.63% and Smallcap 100 gaining 0.70%

depreciating 18 paise to close at a record low, with USD/INR hovering near 94.8-95.1.

BROAD-BASE RALLY

Broader markets outperformed, with the Midcap 100 up 0.63 per cent and Smallcap 100 gaining 0.7 per

cent. Market breadth improved, with 352 of Nifty 500 stocks closing in the green.

Realty led sectoral gains, rising over 2.4 per cent, followed by metal, healthcare, and pharma. IT and media were the session’s laggards. Adani Ports and Eicher

Motors topped Nifty gainers, while Kotak Mahindra Bank and Bharti Airtel bore the brunt of selling.

Going forward, Osho Krishan, Chief Manager-Technical & Derivative Research, Angel One, said market dips are expected to be constructive for buyers, offering opportunities to gradually build long positions.

However, adopting a cautious stance at elevated levels appears prudent in the near term. “With broader market participation improving, traders are advised to adopt a stock-specific approach to capitalise on relative outperformance opportunities while maintaining disciplined risk management,” he cautioned.

Sun TV sheds 5% on DMK defeat

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Shares of the Sun TV Network tumbled as much as 9.4 per cent intra-day on Monday, as a top mid-cap loser, as trends in the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections showed the ruling DMK trailing behind, raising concerns over the broadcaster’s perceived political linkage.

However, the stock ended at ₹575.85, down 4.91 per cent.

According to Kunal Kamble, Bonanza, the stock has broken below its short-term uptrend and key moving averages, signalling a loss of bullish momentum.

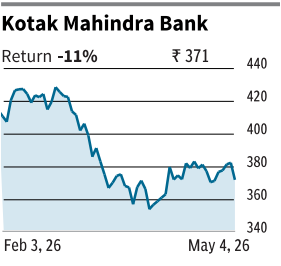
Kotak Bank falls, analysts split on outlook post Q4

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Kotak Mahindra Bank shares ended with a 3 per cent loss on Monday, even as the lender reported a rise in fourth-quarter profit, with the stock reacting to mixed underlying cues and cautious commentary around growth and profitability.

The stock hit a low of ₹363 before recovering slightly to close at ₹371.65, still down about 3 per cent over the previous day’s close, and remained among the top losers in the Nifty 50.

The private sector lender reported a 13 per cent y-o-y increase in standalone net profit at ₹4,027 crore for the March quarter, supported by



steady growth in net interest income and a sharp decline in provisions. While profitability came in ahead of expectations, the market appeared to factor in concerns around sustainability of margins and growth momentum.

MIXED VIEWS

Brokers largely acknowledged the earnings beat but offered a mixed outlook.

Morgan Stanley retained

an ‘Overweight’ rating with a target price of ₹500, calling Q4FY26 a good quarter at attractive valuations. The brokerage highlighted management’s confident commentary and sees the bank as a key pick amid macro risks given earnings resilience.

BofA maintained a ‘Buy’ rating with a target price of ₹460, noting that profit after tax beat estimates, aided by net interest margin expansion and lower provisions. It added that asset quality and margins improved, and expects loan growth momentum to pick up alongside recovery in unsecured lending and lower credit costs.

Macquarie, however, maintained a ‘Neutral’ stance with a target price of ₹460, stating that easing

credit costs should support profitability. It noted that the earnings beat was largely driven by lower credit costs and improvement in retail segments, while margins remained stable due to a better deposit profile.

Elara Capital maintained a ‘Buy’ rating but lowered its target price to ₹473, citing near-term uncertainties.

Meanwhile, Ambit Capital remained more cautious, maintaining a ‘Sell’ rating with a target price of ₹380.

The brokerage flagged concerns over the bank’s ability to balance faster growth with strong underwriting, noting that a shift towards higher-yield unsecured lending could increase operating expenses and credit cost volatility.

NSE launches electronic gold receipts trading

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) has launched trading in electronic gold receipts (EGRs), with physical gold as the underlying commodity.

The exchange has enabled the dematerialisation of a 1,000 g gold bar into an EGR, marking a seamless conversion of physical gold into a secure, tradable electronic instrument within a regulated ecosystem.

GOLD INTEGRATION

By facilitating electronic holding and seamless convertibility between physical and digital formats, EGRs allow investors to participate in the gold market in smaller denominations, offering improved liquidity and flexibility comparable



Sriram Krishnan, Chief Business Development Officer, NSE

to other demat-held financial instruments.

The product is expected to bridge the gap between physical gold and financial markets by offering a regulated, secure and technologically advanced platform for trading the precious metal.

EGRs are dematerialised securities that represent ownership of physical gold stored in SEBI-accredited vaults and held electronically through depositories.

SEBI seeks alignment with RBI on securitisation norms

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed a series of amendments to its securitised debt regulations to align them with the Reserve Bank of India’s 2021 framework for securitisation of standard assets, particularly for transactions by RBI-regulated entities.

The regulator has proposed allowing single-asset securitisation for RBI-regulated entities by exempting them from the cap of 25 per cent of the asset pool for a single obligor as it “restricts listing of SDIs where the underlying comprises a single asset”.

REGULATORY GAP

The existing rules restrict listing of such instruments, even though they are permitted under the latest RBI



framework. SEBI has also proposed removing restrictions that currently prevent securitisation transactions between entities within the same group, provided the originator is RBI-regulated.

The RBI framework does not contain any such prohibition but it requires that the originator should not exercise control over the SPDE or trustee.

GOVERNANCE NORMS

In the governance norms for special purpose distinct entities (SPDEs) where the originator is RBI-regulated,

Each EGR is fully backed by physical gold and is tradable on the exchange, seamlessly integrating gold into the formal financial system.

PRICE DISCOVERY

NSE aims to create a transparent ecosystem for gold trading, enabling efficient price discovery, improved market participation and enhanced trust among stakeholders, including jewellers, refiners, traders and institutional investors.

Sriram Krishnan, Chief Business Development Officer at NSE, said that by creating a seamless, secure and digital pathway for gold investment, the exchange aims to position gold as a modern, integrated asset class within capital markets, reducing reliance on fragmented benchmarks and fostering deeper financial inclusion.

BROKER'S CALL.

SBI Securities

NLC INDIA (BUY)

Target: ₹375

CMP: ₹320.65

NLC India plans to double its total mining capacity from 50.1 million tonnes per annum (mtpa) as of FY25 to 104.4 mtpa by FY30 with a capex of ₹14,199 crore. Lignite mining capacity is expected to increase from 30.1 mtpa to 41.4 mtpa, while coal mining capacity is set to rise from 20 mtpa currently to 62 mtpa, along with establishment of a 1 mtpa critical minerals mining capacity.

With equal focus on the energy businesses, the company plans to nearly double their thermal power capacity to 10 GW by FY30 (capex of ₹49,981 crore), while renewable energy capacity is planned to increase afrom 1.6 GW currently to 10 GW by FY30 (capex of ₹41,599 crore). Additionally, NLC India has earmarked ₹1,101 crore in capex aimed at diversification projects NLC India’s renewable portfolio is projected to scale to around 2 GW by FY26-end, followed by a rapid expansion to 8 GW by FY28 and 10 GW by FY30. The company has formed multiple State-level joint ventures to facilitate large-scale renewable development, while approximately 3 GW of capacity is already under construction. The Pachwara South Coal Block (9 mtpa capacity) commenced mining operations during December 2025. At peak production, the block is expected to meet Ghatampur’s annual coal requirement of about 6 mtpa. For now, production from the Pachwara block is expected to scale towards about 2 mtpa by FY27. The stock trades at FY26E/27E Bloomberg consensus EV/EBITDA multiple of 13.2x/9.3x respectively.

InCred Equities

BAJAJ FINANCE (ADD)

Target: ₹1,200

CMP: ₹950.20

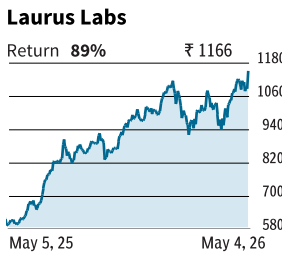
Bajaj Finance reported Q4FY26 PAT of ₹5,500 crore, in line with estimate, led by strong AUM growth, lower-than-expected credit costs offset by rising NIM pressure and higher employee expenses. AUM expanded 22 per cent to ₹5.1 lakh crore, driven by broad-based traction across mortgages, consumer B2C, gold loans, securities lending, urban sales finance, commercial lending and rural sales finance segments. Cautious stance continued in SME lending), although a revival to double-digit growth is guided by Q2-Q3FY27F. New segments such as gold loan, commercial vehicle loans and tractor loans to grow at an accelerated pace. The cross-sell franchise remained an integral feeder to personal loans, car loans and two-wheelers. Non-interest income is expected to grow 16-18 per cent. Gross stage-3 assets ratio declined to 1.01 per cent due to broad-based easing of stress. Credit cost guidance for FY27F is 1.45-1.6 per cent. Calculated NIM stood at 9.5 per cent, while the cost of funds declined to 7.41 per cent, with a guidance of near-term moderation due to geopolitical tensions. Bajaj Finance continues to remain a well-oiled lender, with a superior cross-sell franchise and tech stack providing an edge over peers. We remain watchful for management transition and NIM pressure. Any correction in stock price sweetens the risk-reward ratio. We maintain our Add rating with a target price of ₹1,200, corresponding to about 4.5x FY28F BV and about 23x FY28F EPS.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Laurus Labs (₹1,166.50): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The short-term outlook is bullish for Laurus Labs. The 6 per cent surge on Monday indicates that the upmove in the stock could be gaining momentum.

It also confirms a bull flag formation on the daily chart which in turn strengthens further the bullish case. Immediate support is at ₹1,120.

Below that ₹1,090 is the next strong support which can limit the downside in case the price declines below ₹1,120. Laurus Labs share price can rise to ₹1,300 in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Laurus Labs shares now at ₹1,166. cumulate on dips at ₹1,130. Keep the

stop-loss at ₹1,075. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹1,190 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹1,210. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,220 and ₹1,245 when the price touches ₹1,240 and ₹1,260 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹1,290.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24190 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
24070	23830	24370	24450	Take fresh shorts only below 24070 with a stop-loss at 24110

₹780 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
773	769	785	792	Go long only above 785. Stop-loss can be kept at 782

₹1168 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1160	1150	1175	1190	Take fresh shorts below 1160 with a stop-loss at 1165

₹311 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
310	308	314	318	Go short below 310. Stop-loss can be placed at 311

₹293 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
292	289	295	299	Go long only above 295. Keep the stop-loss at 294

₹1467 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1445	1430	1495	1520	Go long now and at 1455. Keep the stop-loss at 1440

₹1068 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1060	1035	1095	1120	Go long on a bounce from 1160 with a stop-loss at 1155

₹2431 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2420	2400	2460	2480	Go short on a break below 2420. Keep the stop-loss at 2425

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

InGovern asks directors of 7 listed Tata firms to push for Tata Sons listing

Press Trust of India
New Delhi



Shriram Subramanian, MD and Founder, InGovern Research Services

Corporate governance advisory services firm InGovern Research Services has asked directors of seven listed firms of the Tata group to carry out their fiduciary duty to advocate for the listing of Tata Sons to protect public shareholders.

In a letter addressed to the independent directors and board members of the seven listed Tata Group companies holding a collective of about 12 per cent stake in Tata Sons — the holding firm of the Tata Group — InGovern Research Services MD and Founder Shriram Subramanian said the RBI’s 2026 regulatory shifts pose systemic risks to Tata Sons continued private status.

The seven companies are Tata Motors, Tata Steel, Tata Chemicals, Tata Power, Indian Hotels Company Ltd, Tata Consumer Products and Tata Investment Corporation Ltd.

“It is the board’s fiduciary duty to advocate for its listing to protect its public shareholders,” he wrote.

Asking the directors of the seven companies “to publicly articulate their views on its listing”, he said, “The independent directors and board members of the seven listed companies now hold the key to breaking this deadlock.”

To fulfil their duty to their own public shareholders, these boards should adopt a firm, three-part strategy, which includes demanding a roadmap for listing, market-linked valuation and governance reform as a catalyst, the letter added.

LISTING ROADMAP

On the demand for a roadmap for listing, the let-

ter said, “Boards should initiate a formal, documented dialogue requesting a transparent roadmap for the listing of Tata Sons. They should highlight that the RBI’s 2026 regulatory stance makes the current ‘unregistered’ status a reputational and financial risk that the listed entities can no longer afford to carry.” Pushing for market-linked valuation of the companies’ holdings in Tata Sons, the letter said, “It is time to abandon the practice of carrying these holdings at historical cost. Boards should push for periodic re-valuations of their Tata Sons stakes to reflect fair market values.”

This would provide necessary transparency to public investors and pressure the parent entity to acknowledge the unrealised value trapped within its structure, it added.

Calling governance reform as a catalyst, the letter the directors should leverage their combined voting power to push for the board reforms mandated by the Upper Layer NBFC classification, specifically the induction of 50 per cent independent directors at the Tata Sons level.

Subramanian, in the letter, reminded the directors that “the justification for these cross-holdings has long been rooted in a promise made during the leadership of the late Ratan Tata”.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 121.75 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%	
Reliance Ind	1463.10	47.57	20.68	8.93	
HDFC Bank	779.40	25.69	15.14	10.78	
L&T	4100.80	22.22	29.73	4.35	
Adani Ports	1742.60	13.72	31.41	1.16	
ICICI Bank	1270.80	11.54	15.70	8.21	
Hind Unilever	2309.30	11.30	51.27	1.85	
Bajaj Finance	950.20	7.70	30.58	2.30	
Eternal Ltd.	251.90	7.65	664.19	1.64	
Maruti Suzuki	13580.00	7.61	29.09	1.61	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	3860.45	7.05	22.54	1.22	
Eicher Motors	7329.00	6.60	37.53	0.91	
Grasim Ind	2856.00	5.11	20.52	0.98	
Adani Enter	2485.70	4.83	32.27	0.64	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	252.74	4.56	102.87	0.75	
UltraTech Cement	11758.00	4.44	42.31	1.26	
Axis Bank	1275.10	4.25	14.93	3.31	
Sun Pharma	1823.50	3.51	39.95	1.75	
Bajaj Auto	10132.00	3.33	31.88	1.01	
Cipla	1335.00	3.12	23.79	0.68	
Max Healthcare	1011.55	3.00	69.36	0.68	
Bajaj Finserv	1770.40	2.92	14.41	0.92	
Apollo Hosp	7737.50	2.27	59.63	0.72	
TataConsumerProduct	1160.40	2.24	78.03	0.68	
Bharat Elec	433.55	1.76	53.15	1.40	
M&M	3106.50	1.75	22.85	2.51	
Tata Steel	212.24	1.59	29.05	1.59	
Hindalco	1042.70	1.48	14.57	1.36	
NTPC	400.05	0.93	15.62	1.71	
PowerGrid Corp	374.05	0.89	19.11	1.31	
Tata Motors PV	343.50	0.68	46.65	0.65	
Trent Ltd.	4158.50	0.67	85.88	0.83	
JSW Steel	1266.60	0.43	39.88	1.07	
Asian Paints	2448.10	0.35	60.06	1.00	
HDFC Life	588.35	0.34	66.38	0.57	
HCL Tech	1200.50	0.32	19.56	1.15	
SBI Life	1820.10	0.11	73.90	0.74	
Wipro	200.75	0.06	15.87	0.52	
State Bank	1068.40	-0.05	11.40	4.01	
NestleIndia	1457.10	-0.23	80.30	0.94	
Tech Mahindra	1471.60	-0.26	30.00	0.84	
Coal India	479.95	-0.74	9.52	0.99	
Int'lGlobeAvi	4262.40	-1.62	53.79	0.87	
Titan	4363.00	-2.00	81.27	1.63	
Dr Reddys Lab	1287.20	-4.74	19.45	0.71	
ONGC	292.90	-5.63	8.19	10.33	
Infosys	1711.30	-7.99	18.83	2.71	
TCS	2431.30	-9.49	17.72	2.24	
Infocys	1168.40	-10.24	16.08	2.30	
Kotak Bank	371.65	-18.70	19.17	2.47	
Bharti Airtel	1827.10	-39.95	30.05	5.07	

QUICKLY.

India resumes wheat exports after 4 years

Mumbai/New Delhi: Traders have begun exporting wheat for the first time in four years, as ample stocks, higher global prices and firmer freight rates have opened a window for them to make small shipments to buyers in Asia and West Asia, sources said. Consumer goods conglomerate ITC has started loading 22,000 metric tons of wheat at the port of Kandla for shipment to the UAE, sources said. REUTERS

Palm oil slips on firm ringgit, weak crude prices

Kuala Lumpur: Malaysian palm oil futures edged lower on Monday for a second consecutive session, as weaker crude oil prices and a firmer ringgit weighed on the market. The benchmark palm oil contract for July delivery on the Bursa Malaysia Derivatives Exchange slid 13 ringgit, or 0.28 per cent, to 4,557 ringgit (\$1,152.21) a metric ton in early trade. REUTERS

Natural gas: Retain shorts

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl Research Bureau

Natural gas futures has been on a downtrend since mid-March. Last week, the May futures marked a low of ₹248.20 (per mmmBtu) and has now recovered to ₹269.

COMMODITY CALL.

There are no strong signs of a bullish reversal. Although the price is now above the 21-day moving average and the contract has inched above a trendline resistance, both at ₹265, to build a sustainable rally, the

Govt’s rice purchase touches 50 mt

OVERSTOCKED? Centre may be forced to dispose of grain via sales to ethanol distilleries and open market

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The government’s rice procurement for the official reserves during the October 2025-April 2026 period has touched 50 million tonnes (mt), including 1.21 mt from the winter-grown crop.

With over 1.4 mt in April, the procurement is up 6 per cent from the year-ago period.

This high procurement may force the government to dispose of through an aggressive sales policy to ethanol distilleries, States, as well as in the open market.

The government has fixed a target to purchase 56.66 mt of rice during the 2025-26 season (October-September), including 48.7 mt from the kharif-grown crop and 7.96 mt from the rabi season.

Total procurement in 2024-25 from kharif and rabi crops was 54.52 mt in terms of rice.

According to official data,

the actual procurement in terms of rice was 49.86 mt until April 30, against 47.02 mt in the year-ago period.

In FY26, the government sold a record 10.8 mt rice, including 5.2 mt to distilleries for ethanol production, from official reserves, against 4.53 mt in 2024-25.

TELANGANA LEADS

Except Assam, where kharif-grown rice procurement continues till June 30 and Tripura (till May 31), rice purchase from the Kharif season has got over in all the States, including Odisha, where it ended on April 7, and West Bengal (April 30).

The Centre’s rabi season target (between April and September), includes a maximum of 3.5 mt from Telangana, followed by 1.4 mt from Tamil Nadu, 1.1 mt from Odisha and 1.0 mt from Andhra Pradesh.

The first month data show that rabi rice procurement has gone up to 1.21 mt from 1.07 mt a year ago.

Procurement during Oct-March

	2024-25	2025-26	% change
	(in lakh tonnes)		
Punjab	116.13	104.86	-9.7
Haryana	35.99	35.96	-0.1
Tamil Nadu	23.07	21.15	-8.3
Uttar Pradesh	38.66	41.75	8
Chhattisgarh	70	73	4.3
Uttarakhand	4.51	5.02	11.3
Telangana	35.01	40.41	15.4
Andhra Pradesh	19.53	33.53	71.7
West Bengal	18.64	16.71	-10.4
Odisha	40.12	52.69	31.3
Bihar	26.28	25.02	-4.8
Madhya Pradesh	29.16	34.67	18.9
Maharashtra	6.68	6.95	4
Others	6.46	6.92	7.1
All India	470.24	498.64	6

Source: Central Food Grains Procurement Portal

From the Rabi-grown crop, maximum 5.77 lt have been bought from Andhra Pradesh and 5.15 lt from Tamil Nadu.

Also, over 92,000 tonnes have been purchased from Telangana and nearly 26,000

tonnes from Kerala.

The rice marketing season begins from October and the procurement period varies from State to State, depending on the cropping pattern followed in each State. Due to early arrival of the paddy

this year, the Centre allowed procuring agencies in Punjab and Haryana to begin purchase from mid-September and in Tamil Nadu from September 1.

UP 8% IN TAMIL NADU

In Tamil Nadu, the procurement was 8 per cent lower until the end of April at 2.12 mt, whereas the year-ago number was 2.31 mt.

Telangana’s purchase is reported to be 15.4 per cent higher at 4.04 mt from 3.50 mt, while in Andhra Pradesh it has reported at 71.7 per cent rise to 3.35 mt from 1.95 mt a year ago.

In West Bengal, the Centre has been able to buy 1.67 mt of rice this year against 1.86 mt a year ago. Odisha has reported a 31.3 per cent higher purchase at 5.27 mt against 4.01 mt.

Rice procurement in the largest producing State (in kharif season), Uttar Pradesh, has ended at 4.18 mt, which is 8 per cent up from 3.87 mt year-ago.

Price of lithium, used in EV batteries, may surge

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai



Prices of electric vehicles (EV) battery raw material lithium could increase further this year after having gained nearly 50 per cent and increased to a two-year high. However, analysts have said that it will depend on how the Iran war pans out and the demand-supply situation plays out.

“While we expect lithium prices to remain range-bound in the near term, we do not rule out the possibility of prices breaking higher on the back of a stronger-than-expected EV demand impulse, yet contingent on the bridging supply gap, which would limit the scope for sustained gains in 2026,” said research agency BMI, a unit of Fitch Solutions.

“Rapidly rising global investment in clean energy technologies, digital infrastructure and defence-related technologies — all of which rely heavily on critical minerals — is set to sustain strong demand growth,” said the World Bank in its biannual Commodity Markets Outlook.

PRICE OUTLOOK

“Lithium battery shipments for data centre energy storage might rise over 80 per cent in the next five years. This surge in demand from new markets adds to the traditional battery needs of EVs,” said Carboncredits.com website.

BMI said it was raising its 2026 average annual lithium price forecasts to \$17,000/tonne for Chinese lithium carbonate 99.5 per cent and \$16,700/tonne for Chinese lithium hydroxide monohydrate 56.5 per cent, following an out-of-cycle upward revision this year.

Currently, lithium carbonate is ruling at 1,77,000

Chinese yuan (\$25,628) a tonne. Lithium hydroxide is quoted at \$20,690 a tonne.

ENERGY STORAGE

Lithium hydroxide is obtained from lithium carbonate and is an EV battery material. The World Bank said prices of critical minerals like lithium may remain highly sensitive to actual and expected trade restrictions. Environmental permitting challenges and long mine-development lead times are likely to continue constraining output expansion.

Carboncredits.com said rapid growth in stationary energy storage systems, ramping of production by China to meet demand, support for EVs and energy support in Europe and North America, and concerns over supply constraints have lifted lithium prices.

SUPPLIES VULNERABLE

Swift restarts of previously idled higher-cost capacity during a price recovery could prompt production to ramp up quickly, although a protracted bout of disruptions may still be sufficient to sustain an upward price trajectory, it said.

The World Bank said mining and processing remain concentrated in a few countries, leaving global supplies vulnerable to idiosyncratic disruptions and geopolitical stress. BMI said the US-Iran conflict bolstered broader demand expectations for low-carbon industries.

Cotton prices rise by 4% in single day

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Cotton prices saw a sharp increase on Monday with the Cotton Corporation of India (CCI) revising upwards the prices by ₹2,900 per candy (356 kg) by over 4 per cent, following the global price rise. On Monday, cotton for July delivery on the ICE edged up to over 84.5 cents per pound intra-day.

The CCI increased the price by ₹2,900 per candy of 356 kg, the sharpest single day increase this season, according to trade sources. With this increase, the prices are hovering at a two-year high. Cotton futures on the ICE have gained over 28 per cent since the beginning of March till now.

QUANTUM OF INCREASE

From a seasonal low of ₹54,600 per candy, the prices have moved up currently to around ₹65,600 levels.

“This is the highest price



DEMAND SURGES. The demand for Indian cotton yarn has gone up from countries like China, Bangladesh and Vietnam amid the disruption in the global supply chain due to the ongoing war

in the past two seasons and the quantum of increase by CCI has surprised the trade. It is said that CCI has sold over more than two lakh bales despite the price increase,” said Ramanuj Das Boob, a sourcing agent in Raichur.

The increase in the prices of cotton and yarn has already started facing resistance from fabric makers. “From airtel to conventional looms, there is a significant shortage of workers, leading

to major delays in fabric deliveries. At the same time, due to the sharp rise in yarn prices, even lower-level deliveries are getting delayed,” Das Boob said.

DEMAND ABROAD

In recent weeks, the demand for Indian cotton yarn has also gone up from countries such as China, Bangladesh and Vietnam amidst the disruption in the global supply chain due to the ongoing war in West Asia.

ticipants took a pledge to incorporate one millet-based meal into their daily routine, spread awareness about the benefits of millets, and nominate three others to join the movement. This chain-based outreach is expected to accelerate the campaign’s reach across India and, eventually, globally,” Millet Marvels Founder-CEO Bharat Reddy said.

SUSTAINABLE LIFE

“This initiative marks the beginning of a transformative journey, a people’s movement toward embracing millets as a sustainable and nutritious way of life,” Reddy, a doctor-cum-actor, said.



ICAR-IIMR Director Tara Satyavathi pointed out that the National Institute of Nutrition recommended that millets should constitute one-third of the cereals we consume and can be included in any meal of the day.

“Millets truly deserve their reputation as superfoods. With nine diverse varieties, each offering

March tea output declines by 1.5% to 66.86 mkg

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Tea production continued its downward trend as the output declined in March by 1.5 per cent to 66.86 million kg (mkg) from 67.85 mkg a year ago.

The decline was mainly in North India, where production is yet to recover due to climatic and seasonal issues, whereas South India registered a 13 per cent increase during the month.

Adverse weather conditions have been influencing tea production in the country in recent months.

ASSAM DRAGS NORTH

As per the Tea Board’s latest production data, the output in North India declined 5.8 per cent to 49.05 mkg during March 2026 over the corresponding last month’s 52.08 mkg. The production in the north was mainly dragged by a sharp decline in output in Assam, where total produc-



WANING AROMA. The decline was mainly in North India, where production is yet to recover due to climatic issues, whereas South registered a 13% increase during the month REUTERS

tion fell 39 per cent to 17.38 mkg (28.61 mkg).

In the Assam Valley region, production declined to 16.77 mkg (27.75 mkg), while in Cachar, the output declined marginally to 0.61 mkg (0.86 mkg).

However, the production in West Bengal increased 37 per cent to 29.96 mkg (21.81 mkg during March 2025).

The output in Bengal improved in all three main producing regions of Dooars, Terai and Darjeeling.

In Dooars, the output during March increased to 16.35 mkg (11.79 mkg), while in Terai it improved to 13.44 mkg (9.90 mkg) and in Darjeeling to 0.17 mkg (0.12 mkg). In the other producing regions of North India, the output improved marginally to 1.71 m kg during March from 1.66 mkg a year ago.

TN, KERALA SEE RISE

In South India, production was up 13 per cent at 17.81 mkg during March against

Production in West Bengal increased 37% to 29.96 mkg (21.81 mkg during March 2025)

15.77 mkg a year ago. The increase in production was witnessed both in Tamil Nadu and Kerala.

In Tamil Nadu, the March tea output improved to 12.85 mkg (11.06 mkg), while in Kerala production was up at 4.59 mkg (4.32 mkg). However, Karnataka saw a marginal decline to 0.37 mkg (0.39 mkg). Overall production by small growers across the country saw a marginal increase at 40.79 mkg (40.60 mkg), while the share of big growers reduced marginally to 20.07 mkg (22.25 mkg).

Categorywise production of CTC teas stood at 60.33 mkg, while the orthodox tea was at 5.59 mkg and green tea at 0.94 mkg.

Fertilizer industry hails Maharashtra’s move to streamline quality inspections

Our Bureau
Chennai

The consortium of fertilizer industry associations, IPNM SPC, has welcomed the Maharashtra government’s decisions to streamline quality inspections for fertilizers, strengthen quality control and ban the bundling of subsidised and non-subsidised fertilizers.

“The industry views these decisions as a positive step towards building a more transparent, efficient and farmer-focused agri-input system,” it said in a statement.

The decisions were taken at a meeting chaired by State Agriculture Minister Datatray Vithoba Bharne on April 28, in Mumbai.

DECISIONS REACHED

A key outcome of the meeting was the rationalisation of



the quality control inspection (QCI) system, where responsibilities have been clearly restructured across the taluk, district, divisional and State levels.

By streamlining the role of inspectors, including part-time inspectors where required, the government has addressed a long-pending demand of the industry, it said.

“This is expected to reduce duplication, bring clarity and make inspections more effective rather than excessive,” said the consor-

tium. It said the new framework also brings in a more practical system of inspections.

It focuses on planned and need-based checks, supported by technology-driven platforms, along with provisions for randomised inspections and lot-wise sample testing. At the same time, stronger monitoring at higher levels will ensure better coordination and timely action.

Another key decision is the ban on forcibly bundling and selling non-subsidised products with subsidised fertilizers, an issue that IPNM SPC had raised. A policy similar to that of Uttar Pradesh is under active consideration and is expected to be notified soon, said the group.

The approach strengthens action against challenges such as black marketing, hoarding and spurious inputs, it said.

Crude oil rises as Iran attacks tanker with drones

Bloomberg

Crude oil rose on signs of heightened tensions in the Strait of Hormuz as Iran attacked a tanker with drones and the US said it’s working to evacuate stranded ships through the vital waterway.

Brent spiked more than 5 per cent to trade above \$114 a barrel, before paring some of the gain as prices fluctuated sharply. Futures reached intra-day highs following Iranian media reports claiming two missiles hit an American patrol boat, which the US Central Command denied.

The escalation comes after President Donald Trump said the US would guide vessels out of Hormuz, framing the plan as a “humanitarian gesture.”

Iran said US forces would be attacked if they entered the waterway and Iran’s semi-official news agency



later said Tehran “redefined the control zone” in the strait, effectively setting out a wider area to regulate shipping in the region.

The US move was followed by increased tensions. A unit of the UAE’s Abu Dhabi National Oil Co said its oil tanker *Barakah*, which wasn’t carrying any cargo, was targeted by two Iranian drones off the coast of Oman. On Sunday, there was a report of a bulk carrier being attacked by small boats, according to the UK Maritime Trade Operations.

Rajasthan farmers appeal to Centre to buy 100% chana or reimburse difference

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Pointing out glaring violations of the standard operating procedures (SOPs) on pulses procurement, which has assured 100 per cent purchase at minimum support price (MSP) from registered farmers, the Kisan Mahapanchayat has sought Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh’s Chouhan’s intervention in Rajasthan so that chana (gram) farmers are saved from losing an average ₹3 lakh due to 40 quintal sales cap, amid lower market rates.

In a letter to Chouhan, Kisan Mahapanchayat’s Rampal Jat said that over 5,000 chana farmers had already been registered in Rajasthan to sell their produce to the government at an MSP of ₹5,875 per quintal. However, they are unable

to sell as procurement has not commenced in all growing districts and also refusal by the procuring agencies to buy above 40 quintals.

“Procurement of chana in Rajasthan has commenced only in Kishangarh (Ajmer district). Even there, farmers who registered with Rajfed, the nodal State agency, and whose procurement has already reached the prescribed limit of 40 quintals, are being excluded from the Central scheme that allows 100 per cent purchase.”

CUSHION AGAINST LOSS

Noting that current market rates of chana are ₹5,000-₹5,200 per quintal, as a cap of 40 quintals purchase is enforced, Jat said farmers will be compelled to sell the remaining produce at a loss of ₹775 per quintal.

“In accordance with the SOP prescribed by the welfare-oriented government,

the procurement of every single grain of produce is imperative,” he said.

“A farmer who has produced about 400 quintal of chana on the promise that he would be able to get MSP after launch of the Pulses Mission would be forced to sell 360 quintal in the open market at a loss of ₹2.5-3 lakh because of the government’s denial,” he said and demanded that the cap should be removed and the entire produce bought from farmers.

Jat suggested a ‘Price Deficiency Payment Scheme’ (PDPS) in Rajasthan if the government is unable to buy the entire produce, so that farmers can recover their loss after selling in the open market. Under the PDPS, the Centre pays the differential price between the MSP and the modal rate directly to farmers when the open market prices rule lower.

QUICKLY.

GRAP-1 restrictions
revoked in Delhi-NCR

New Delhi: GRAP-1 restrictions in Delhi-NCR have been revoked after an improvement in air quality, officials said. The Commission for Air Quality Management said that owing to favourable meteorological conditions, the air quality index of Delhi was recorded at 88 on Monday. “Further, the forecast by IMD and IITM indicates that AQI is likely to remain in the moderate category in the coming days,” an official said. »

Thermax, Ankur Scientific
plan green methanol plant

New Delhi: Thermax on Monday announced a collaboration with Ankur Scientific to set up India's first green methanol production facility at the Deendayal Port Authority, Kandla, Gujarat. The collaboration brings together Thermax's expertise in fuel and chemical processing with Ankur Scientific's advanced biomass gasification technology, a company statement said. »

India, Canada begin second round of free trade talks, eye \$50 b trade by 2030

WARMING UP. The meeting is likely to set the tone for Commerce Minister Goyal's visit to Canada later this month

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Shaking off the diplomatic ice, India and Canada on Monday started the second round of negotiations for a free trade agreement, aimed at increasing bilateral trade to \$50 billion by 2030.

The two sides are hoping to conclude the pact by the year-end, signalling an uptick in bilateral engagement.

TRADE TALKS

“The five-day talks between the two negotiating teams for the India-Canada CEPA started in New Delhi on Monday. The attempt is to fast-track talks so that the pact can be concluded by the year-end as decided by the Prime Ministers earlier this year,” a person tracking the meeting told *businessline*.

The meeting is also likely



DEAL PUSH. The two sides are hoping to conclude the pact by the year-end ISTOCK/RUSKIP

to set the tone for Commerce & Industry Minister Piyush Goyal's visit to Canada later this month, heading a business delegation.

KEY MEETING

The first round of negotiations for the pact, officially called the India-Canada

Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA), took place in March this year following Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney's meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi.

The summit meeting was key to the resetting of ties

that had hit rock bottom in 2023 when former Canadian PM Justin Trudeau accused Indian authorities of being involved in the murder of Canadian Sikh separatist Hardeep Singh Nijjar.

“The leaders expressed confidence that a comprehensive trade framework would serve as a durable economic anchor for the partnership and support the shared aspiration of expanding bilateral trade to C\$70 billion/₹4.65 lakh crore by 2030. They welcomed the finalisation and signing of the Terms of Reference for CEPA negotiations and the launch of formal negotiations and expressed their shared commitment to conclude the talks by the end of 2026,” per a joint statement issued after Carney's meeting with Modi in March.

India-Canada bilateral trade in goods was at \$8.66

billion in 2024-25, while India's exports to the country were at \$4.22 billion.

INDIA'S EXPORTS

Major items of India's exports to Canada include pharmaceutical products, machinery parts & mechanical appliances, iron & steel articles, electronic goods, organic chemicals, jewellery, gems & precious stones, clothing & textile articles, seafood, engineering goods and auto parts.

India's major imports from Canada include pulses, fertilizers (potash), mineral fuels, wood pulp, gems & precious stones (diamonds), aircraft parts, machinery parts, paper & paperboard and iron & aluminium scrap.

India's main services sector exports include telecommunications, computers, information services, and other business services.

CSB Bank reports 6% increase in Q4 net profit at ₹202 crore

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Pralay Mondal, MD & CEO, CSB Bank

CSB Bank reported a 6 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) increase in the fourth quarter (Q4FY26) net profit at ₹202 crore against ₹190 crore in the year-ago quarter on the back of a robust rise in net interest income and a sharp decline in loan loss provisions.

In FY26, the Thrissur (Kerala)-headquartered Bank's net profit rose 7 per cent at 633 crore (₹594 crore). Net interest income (difference between interest earned and interest expended) was up 25 per cent y-o-y at ₹464 crore (₹371 crore). Other income, including fee-based income, treasury income and recovery in written-off accounts, declined 20 per cent y-o-y to ₹306 crore (₹381 crore).

Loan loss provisions saw a sharp 78 per cent y-o-y fall to ₹11 crore (₹49 crore).

As of March-end 2026, deposits and gross advances were up 20 per cent y-o-y at ₹44,246 crore and 27 per cent at ₹40,359 crore, respectively.

OVERALL DEPOSITS

Within overall deposits, the proportion of low-cost current account, savings account (CASA) deposits declined to 20 per cent from 24 per cent a year ago.

Within gross advances, the proportion of gold loans increased to 53 per cent from 44 per cent.

The advances growth was powered by gold loans, which grew 53 per cent, followed by wholesale loans, up 37 per cent.

Loans under the business lending category nudged up 2.6 per cent, and retail loans declined 28 per cent.

Pralay Mondal, MD & CEO, attributed the de-

growth in retail loans to the re-classification of loans against security, where the collateral was gold, and a decline in unsecured loans, among others.

“So, next year, the retail portfolio will grow... The wholesale loan portfolio is growing fast because we have the transaction banking system in place. So, we expect this business to continue to grow well.”

HIGHER GNPA

Gross non-performing assets (GNPAs) position deteriorated to 1.66 per cent of gross advances as of March-end 2026 against 1.57 per cent as of March-end 2025. Net NPAs position, however, improved to 0.40 per cent of net advances against 0.52 per cent.

Mondal said, “GNPAs are high compared to last year because of some slippages in the first, second and third quarters. But on an inventory basis, at the end of the fourth quarter, most of them have been upgraded and recovered.”

Net interest margin increased to 3.83 per cent in Q4FY26 from 3.75 per cent in Q4FY25.

CSB Bank's shares rose 2.73 per cent to close at ₹391.95 apiece on BSE over the previous close of ₹381.55.

Vande Bharat ridership surge reshapes Kashmir travel

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar



ON THE RIGHT TRACK. Nearly 3,925 passengers travelled on the Vande Bharat train on its inaugural run on May 2, and 5,000 on the second day BASIT ZARGAR

A surge in ridership on the Vande Bharat Express between Jammu and Srinagar amid elevated airfares is beginning to impact not just airlines but also road transport operators, with taxi and bus unions flagging concerns over declining demand.

RAIL SHIFT

Railway data show that nearly 3,925 passengers travelled on the train on its inaugural run on May 2, with the number crossing 5,000 on the second day.

The train's fare of around

₹730 (excluding catering), compared with airfares of ₹4,000-₹6,000, has made it

an attractive option.

“It is cheaper than flights and far safer and more com-

fortable than a long and treacherous mountainous road journey,” said

Mohmmad Afzal Malik, a passenger at the Srinagar railway station. However, the shift is being felt by local transporters. Sheikh Mohammad Yousuf, General Secretary of the All Jammu and Kashmir Transport Welfare Association, said nearly 70,000 cabs operate across the Union Territory and are likely to be affected if the trend continues.

“We are not against rail transport, and we welcome the premium Vande Bharat Express, but the government must formulate a policy for thousands of cabs and other drivers plying on the Jammu-Srinagar National Highway,” said Yousuf. Bus operators, too,

are closely watching the development.

EMERGING TREND

Industry observers cautioned that the current surge may partly be driven by initial enthusiasm and high airfare levels, and could stabilise over time.

“Much will depend on the train's ability to maintain punctuality, ticket availability and service quality as demand grows,” said a transporter. Even so, the early response suggests that the Vande Bharat Express is not just an alternative to flights but is also beginning to reshape the economics of road transport on one of the region's most critical routes.

Adani Enterprises plans ₹40,000 cr capex in FY27 with ₹17,000 cr for growing airports biz

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad



Adani Enterprises Ltd (AEL) will channel over 42 per cent of its planned ₹40,000 crore capital expenditure for FY27 into its airports business, including the construction of a terminal in Ahmedabad ahead of the Commonwealth Games 2030.

Out of the total planned capex, around ₹17,000 crore has been earmarked for airports, making it the largest investment segment, CFO Jugeshinder Singh said.

CAPEX MOMENTUM

“We were close to 95 per cent of our target capex for FY26. It has been a very good year from that point of view. We expect the capex for FY27 to be at the same

level, around ₹40,000 crore,” Singh told investors recently.

AEL is also accelerating expansion at the Navi Mumbai International Airport, with Phase II set to begin as traffic ramps up.

“All the traffic projections for Navi Mumbai, Mumbai and the MMR region show that we will reach capacity at Navi Mumbai in 12-18 months. We are accelerating this project,” he said.

The company is also accelerating development at Navi Mumbai International Airport, amid rising traffic projections

in FY26, driven by higher traffic and improved monetisation. The company said it has transitioned to a more infrastructure-led model, with around 80 per cent of EBITDA coming from mature, long-term-contracted businesses, enhancing earnings visibility.

OTHER SECTORS

The remaining capex will be distributed across PVC (₹9,000 crore), natural resources and mining (₹4,000 crore) and new energy businesses, including hydrogen (₹10,000 crore), reflecting AEL's diversified infrastructure push. AEL said its incubation journey had moved beyond the initial capex-heavy phase, with a growing share of stable earnings positioning it for sustained cash generation and future value unlock.

Beyond experimentation, enterprises embed GenAI, agentic AI in workflows

Sanjana B
Bengaluru



Agentic AI is a technology shift equivalent to the internet and cloud. We are seeing massive adoption

SATINDER PAL SINGH

irector of Solution Architecture, AWS India and South Asia



Enterprises in India and also globally are rapidly shifting from AI experimentation to real-world deployment, with agentic and generative AI moving into the core of business operations, according to Satinder Pal Singh, Director of Solution Architecture, AWS India and South Asia.

“Over the last few months, we have seen massive adoption for GenAI and agentic AI. Customers realise that AI is a technological and once-in-a-lifetime shift, and they want to harness this to innovate in their business platforms,” he noted, adding that agentic AI specifically is gaining momentum in various production use cases.

One example is Zomato's Nugget platform, which leverages AWS Bedrock. It has processed almost 1 billion messages with 40 per cent productivity improvement, which is a massive gain at scale.

THREE FACTORS

He identified three key success factors: Selecting the right models amid rapid

technological change, building robust data platforms for Generative AI to be useful, and for agentic AI systems to deliver business outcomes.

The third factor is investing in continuous skilling since the technology is changing so fast.

AWS has trained over 7 million people in India across areas from application modernisation to gener-

ative AI. “Generative AI is such a powerful technology that virtually every type of customer and industry can innovate and benefit from it. Customers are innovating, and that is leading to the massive adoption of agentic AI and GenAI. The technology is so broad that everyone benefits from it,” Singh noted.

He added, “Agentic AI is a technology shift equivalent to the internet and cloud. We are seeing massive adoption. Customers are incorporating agentic AI into their complex workflows. The capabilities of agentic AI and its potential make me excited about what we can deliver.”

On data sovereignty, he said AWS is “sovereign by design,” enabling customers to decide where their data is stored, like within the Mumbai or Hyderabad region.

Prudent Corporate launches AI platform ‘Edge+’ for mutual fund distributors

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Prudent Corporate Advisory Services Ltd has launched an AI-powered business management platform, Edge+, to help mutual fund distributors (MFDs) enhance client servicing, improve productivity and drive business growth.

The platform integrates capabilities such as goal-based planning, business analytics, marketing automation and research tools under a single interface, said the company.

Distributors can generate asset allocation strategies across equity, debt and hybrid instruments based on client risk profiles and investment horizons, along with curated scheme recommendations, and initiate

transactions from the same interface.

Edge+ also enables distributors to identify growth opportunities within their existing book through age-wise and AUM-wise segmentation, track SIP trends and visibility into external assets, allowing more targeted client engagement. Built-in communication tools allow partners to reach clients with ready-made messaging.

PLATFORM EXPANSION

The platform also enables distributors to expand beyond mutual funds into insurance, broking, PMS/AIFs, fixed deposits, bonds and NPS, supporting cross-selling and broader client engagement. Edge+ is currently available in beta version to the company's distribution partners.

Govt will turn Madhya Pradesh into milk capital of India: CM Mohan Yadav

Press Trust of India
Gwalior



Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav

The Madhya Pradesh government will promote cattle rearers and boost dairy investment to make the state the country's “milk capital”, Chief Minister Mohan Yadav said on Monday.

Addressing a State-level conference of dairy farmers and milk producers in Gwalior, Yadav said the dairy sector forms the backbone of the rural economy, and the government remains committed to farmers' prosperity.

He added that the government aims to make Madhya Pradesh a leading milk-producing State and identified Gwalior as a key contributor.

Yadav performed the foundation-laying ceremony for Rishi Galav University in Gwalior.

“Today is a very special

day. The university foundation ceremony and blessings of the cow hold significance. Soldiers guarding the borders and farmers in fields are equal,” he said.

Yadav said the government is observing a farmer welfare year and focusing on agriculturists, women, youth and the poor.

He said the State had disbursed ₹55,000 crore under the Ladli Behna Scheme and continues to support farm-

ers through welfare initiatives. He said wheat procurement will take place at ₹2,625 per quintal and added that river-linking projects will provide irrigation to farms, adding that wheat production had reached record levels and farmers were also earning through milk production.

Yadav also said that the government will provide assistance up to ₹10 lakh to promote dairy units and ensure fair prices for milk producers.

He said Madhya Pradesh ranks third in milk production and aims to become number one in the country.

Yadav announced plans to open an animal feed unit and wellness centre in Gwalior and a veterinary hospital in Dabra. He said the government will provide compensation at four times the guideline rate for land acquisition.

Andhra Pradesh to integrate economic regions with logistics network

Our Bureau
Hyderabad



Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu on Monday directed officials to work on enhancing connectivity between major industrial parks and economic regions in the State.

At a review meeting held in Amaravati on Monday, the Chief Minister reviewed the development of Product Perfection Clusters across the Visakhapatnam, Amaravati and Tirupati economic regions and discussed modalities for developing industrial and chemical parks under the Centre's BHAVYA (Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana) scheme.

RARE EARTH PARK

He also directed officials to prepare plans for setting up a Rare Earth Mineral Park in 2026-27, developing the East

Coast Industrial Corridor, establishing a container manufacturing cluster and setting up around 175 MSME parks across the State.

Logistics integration must align with product perfection in industrial parks, he said, adding that essential infrastructure such as water, power, cold storage and warehousing should be provided to improve efficiency.

Stating that achieving

global quality standards was essential for local products to access regional, national and international markets, the Chief Minister directed the officials to encourage MSME units to meet international benchmarks.

Farmer producer organisations (FPOs) should be set up within industrial clusters to extend benefits to the farming community, according to an official release.

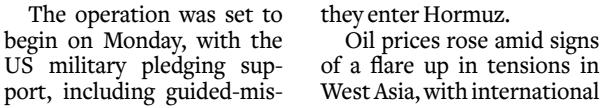
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PEACE MIRE. Trump announces 'Project Freedom' to free ships stranded in Strait of Hormuz; Iran claims US Navy ships struck

The attack follows Presid-



When announcing the plans to guide stranded ships out of the Persian Gulf — dubbed Project Freedom —

IMPASSE CONTINUES

An "enhanced security area" has been established by the US to support transits, ac-

He has struck a similar tone in recent weeks, but negotiations have yet to break the deadlock.



"This marks the second generic semaglutide approval in Canada, positioning OneSource partners as the first generic entrants in one of the world's most significant semaglutide mar-

OneSource's first approval was through partner Dr. Reddy's Laboratories, who also received approval for generic semaglutide in Canada, late in April.

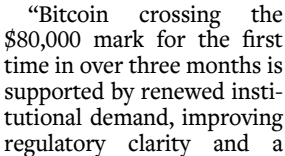
Further, it added, that many generic medications were 45 to 90 per cent cheaper than the brand name versions in Canada. Neeraj Sharma, OnceSource Chief Executive and Managing Director, said the development reflected “the strength of our CDMO platform, our compliance standards, technical expertise and ability to scale complex drug-device-combination programs for highly regulated markets.”

TRAVEL DEMAND

Despite disruption from the conflict, Dubai International and Al Maktoum International airports handled more

Before the war broke out and Gulf airspace closures disrupted traffic for nearly two months, DXB was expected to handle close to 100 million passengers this year, its operator said on February 11.

Riya Sehgal, Research Analyst, Delta Exchange, explained that the primary catalyst behind the move remains strong institutional participation through spot Bitcoin ETFs, with recent inflows signalling steady demand from larger investors.



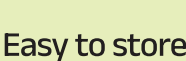
mand is persisting despite a challenging macro backdrop. He said that the Fidelity Wise Origin Bitcoin Fund recorded fresh inflows of \$26.6 million early this month. The



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Honourable Union Home Minister and
Minister of Cooperation
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